Grade 7 practice paper 1

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

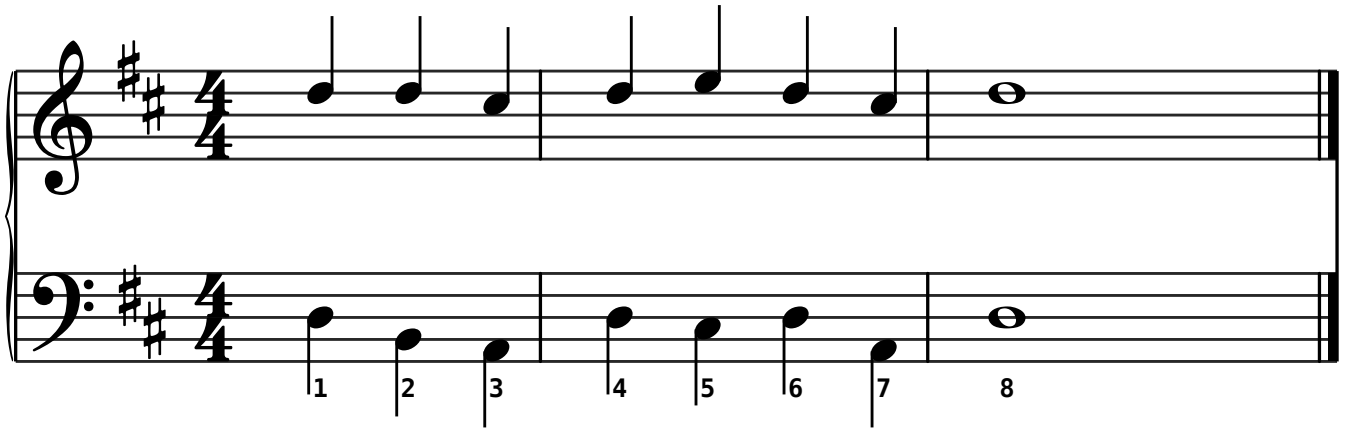
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 7 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each; question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: Figuring a bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. The melody and bass are given (D major). Choose the figures for each bass note to show the chords. A blank (5/3) means a root-position triad.
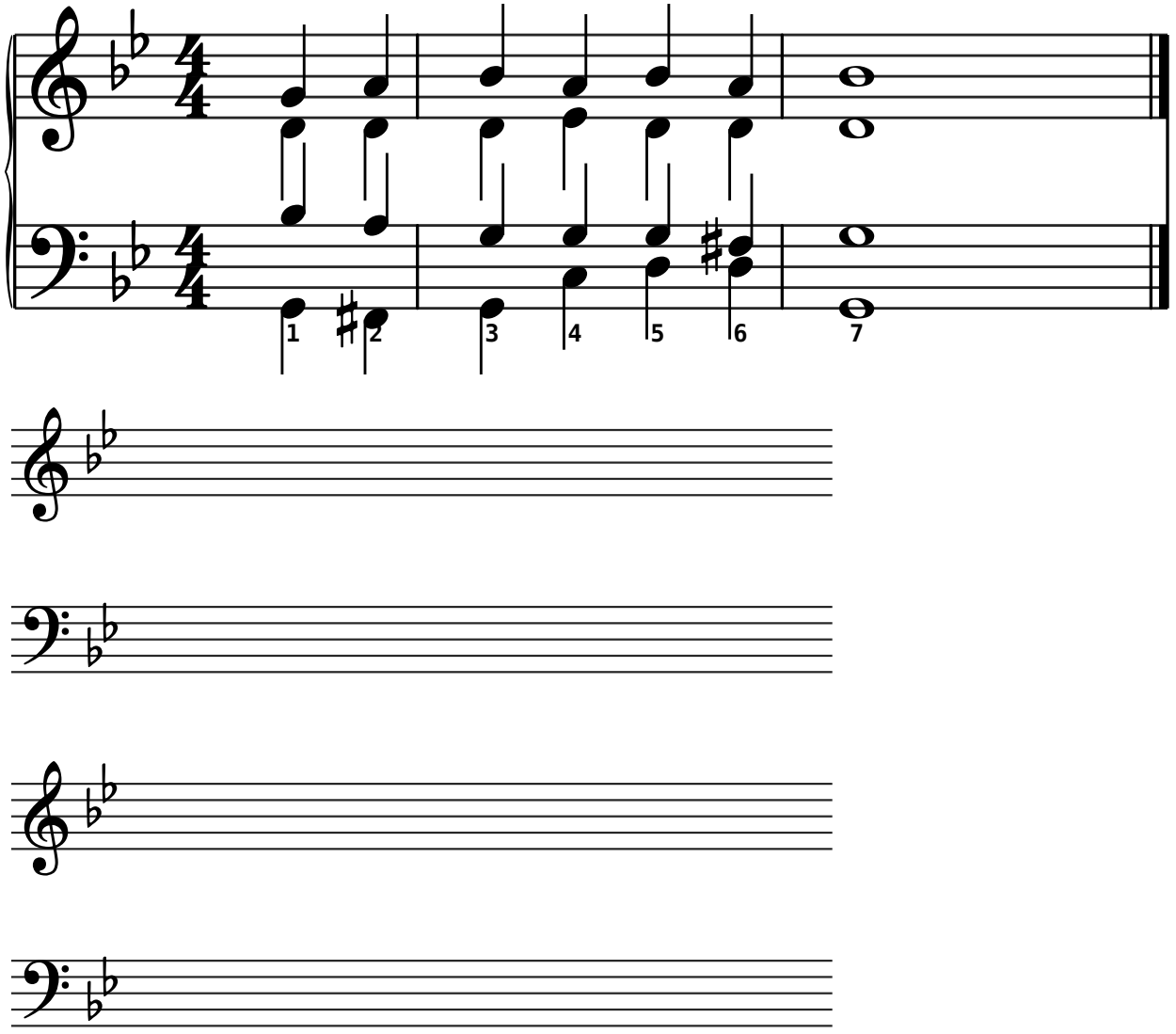


Write the figures under each bass note.

Question 2: Suspensions and decoration (15 marks)

15 marks
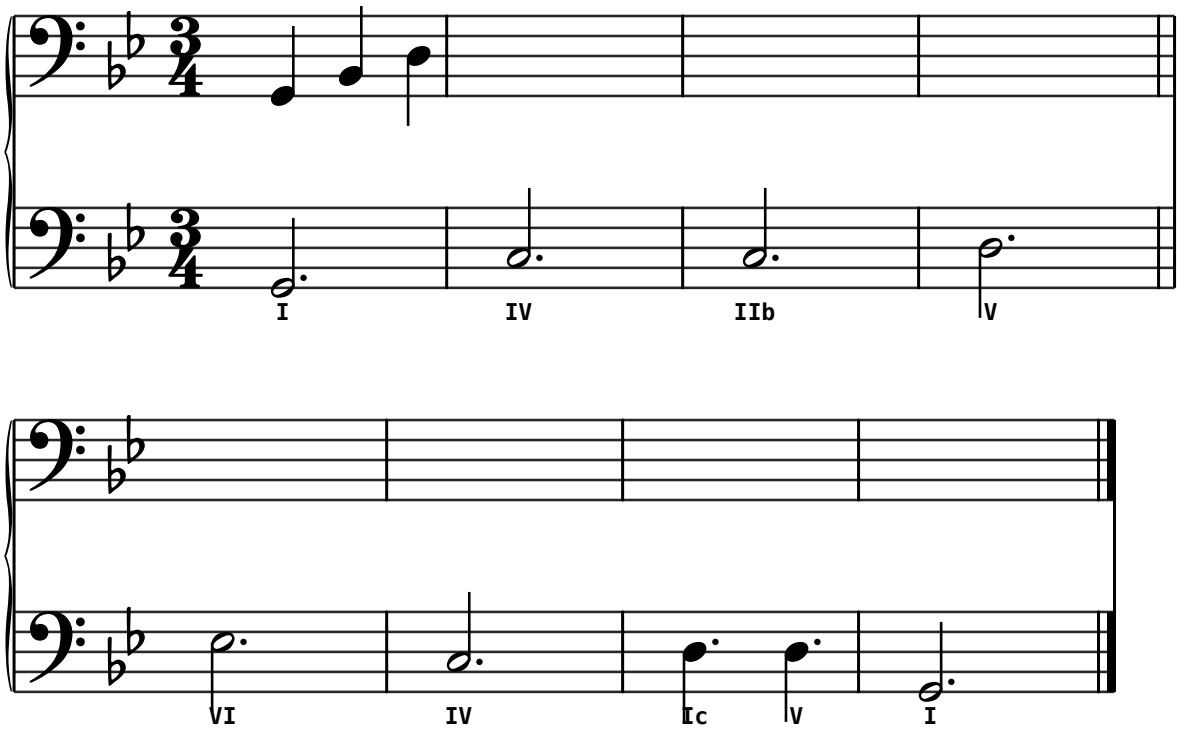
2. Rewrite this passage (G minor) adding at least two suspensions and some melodic decoration (passing notes, auxiliary notes, anticipations). Keep the harmony the same.



Question 3: Composition **(20 marks)**

20 marks

3. Composition: write a melody for cello over this chord plan (G minor). The first bar is given; continue it to the end of bar 8. Add a tempo, dynamics and phrasing.
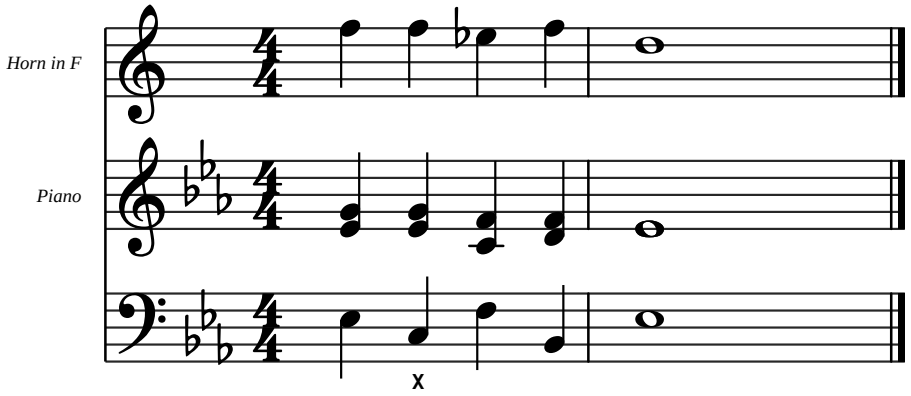


cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Question 4: A solo instrument with piano (25 marks)

3 marks

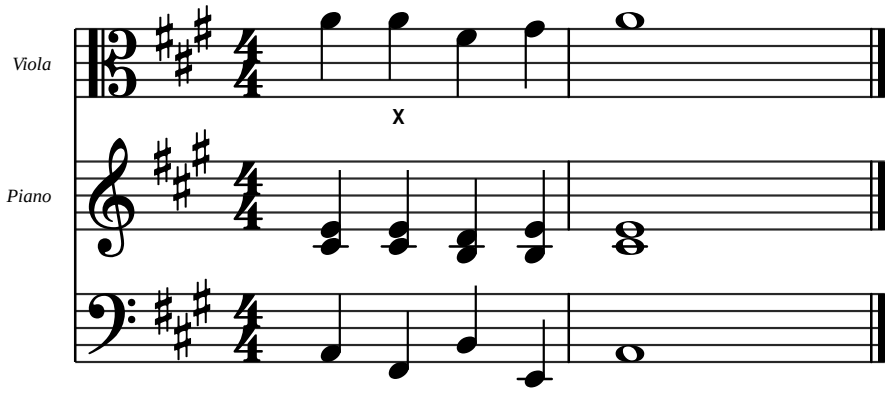
4. The music sounds in E♭ major. Name the chord at X (solo and piano together; remember the solo transposes).



A. IVc B. V7c C. II D. VI7

3 marks

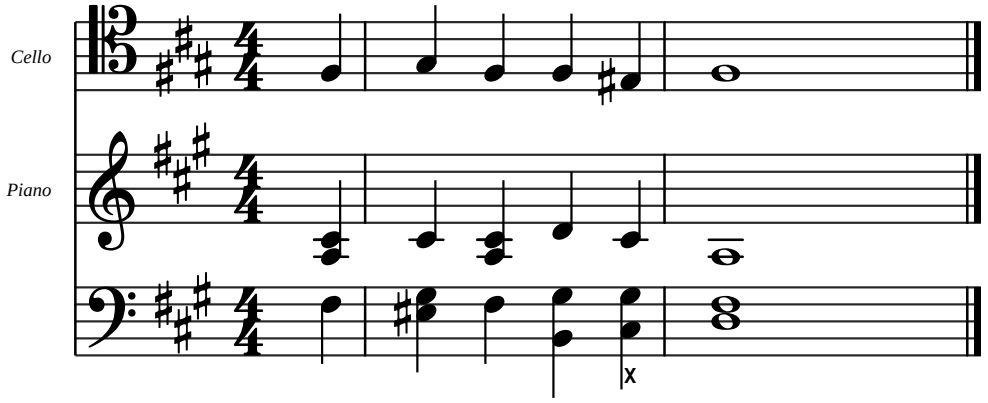
5. Name the viola's note marked X (alto clef). Give the octave too: middle C is C4.



A. A3 B. C♯5 C. G♯4 D. A4

3 marks

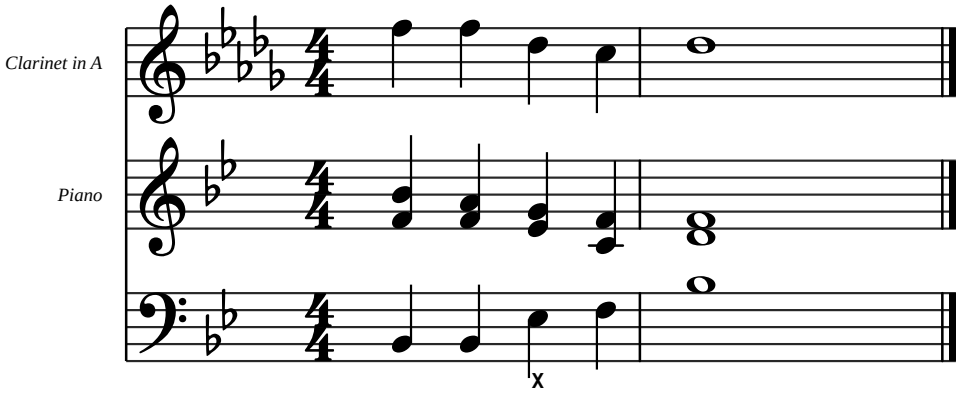
6. The music sounds in F♯ minor. Name the chord at X (solo and piano together; remember the solo transposes).



A. I B. V C. IV7 D. IIb

3 marks

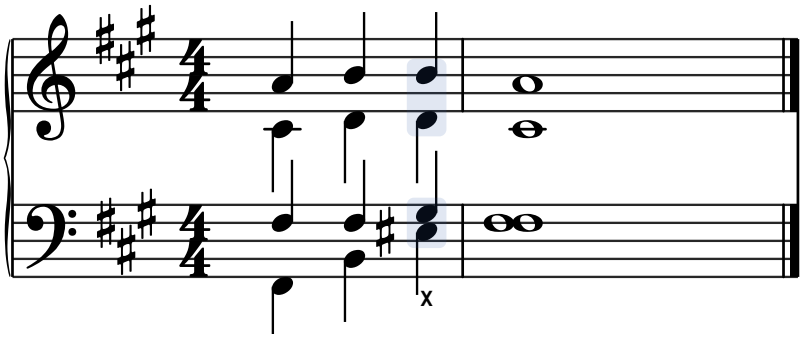
7. The music sounds in B♭ major. Name the chord at X (solo and piano together; remember the solo transposes).



A. VI B. V7 C. VII7c D. IV

3 marks

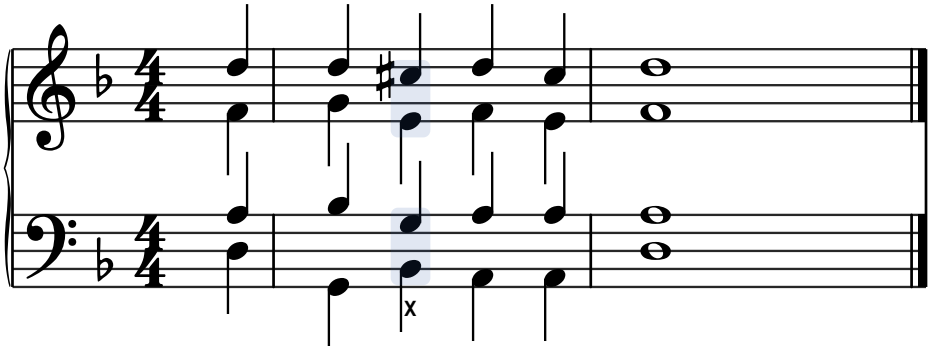
8. This passage is in F♯ minor. Name the chord marked X.



A. V7d B. VII7 C. VII7c D. IV7d

3 marks

9. This passage is in D minor. What kind of chord is X?



A. a Neapolitan 6th B. a secondary 7th C. a dominant 7th D. a diminished 7th

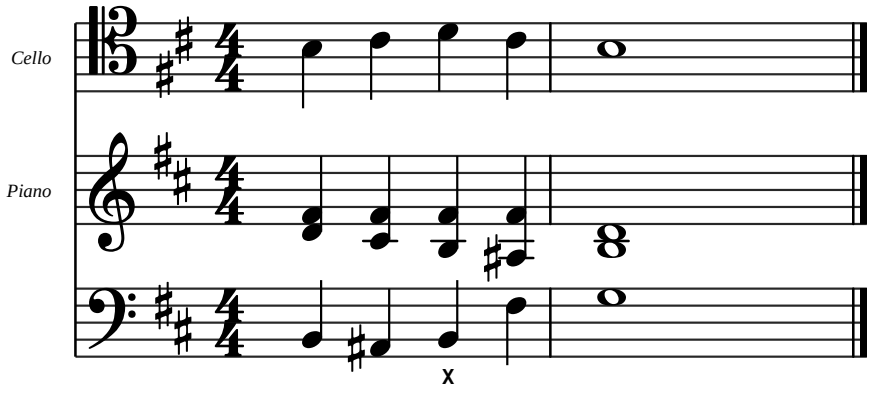
3 marks

10. An anticipation is...

A. a note of the next chord, sounded early B. a leap to a dissonance C. a note a step above, then back D. a held note from the chord before

4 marks

11. The music sounds in B minor. Name the chord at X (solo and piano together; remember the solo transposes).
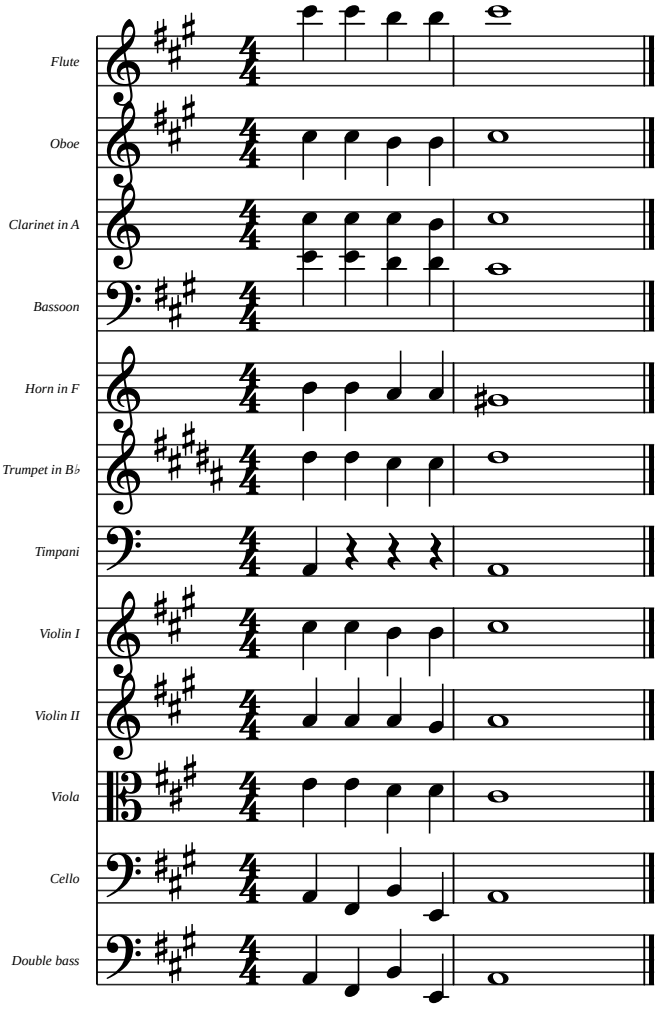


A. N6 B. I C. I7 D. Vb

Question 5: An orchestral score (25 marks)

3 marks

12. The double bass and cello are written on the same notes here. How do they sound?



A. they sound in unison

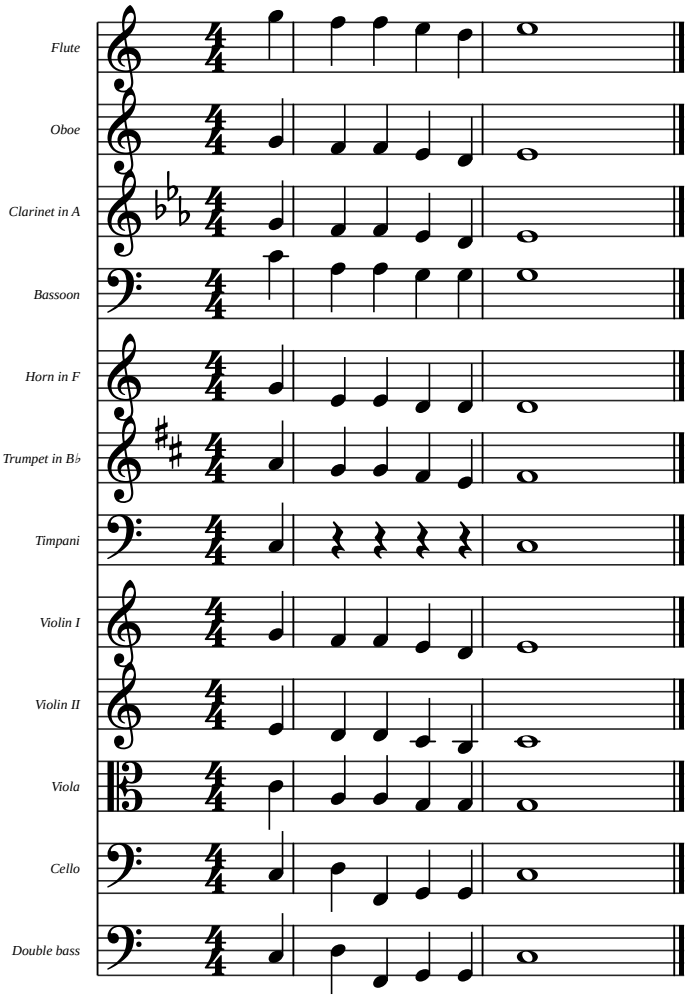
B. the double bass sounds an octave lower

C. the cello sounds an octave lower

D. the double bass sounds an octave higher

3 marks

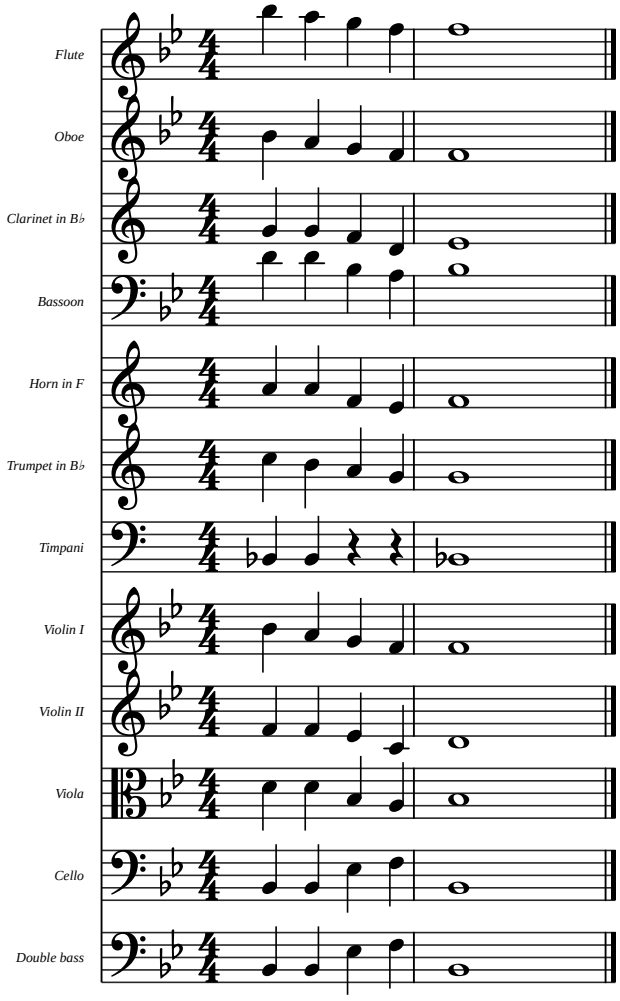
13. In score order, which family comes straight after the brass?



A. woodwind B. strings C. percussion D. voices

3 marks
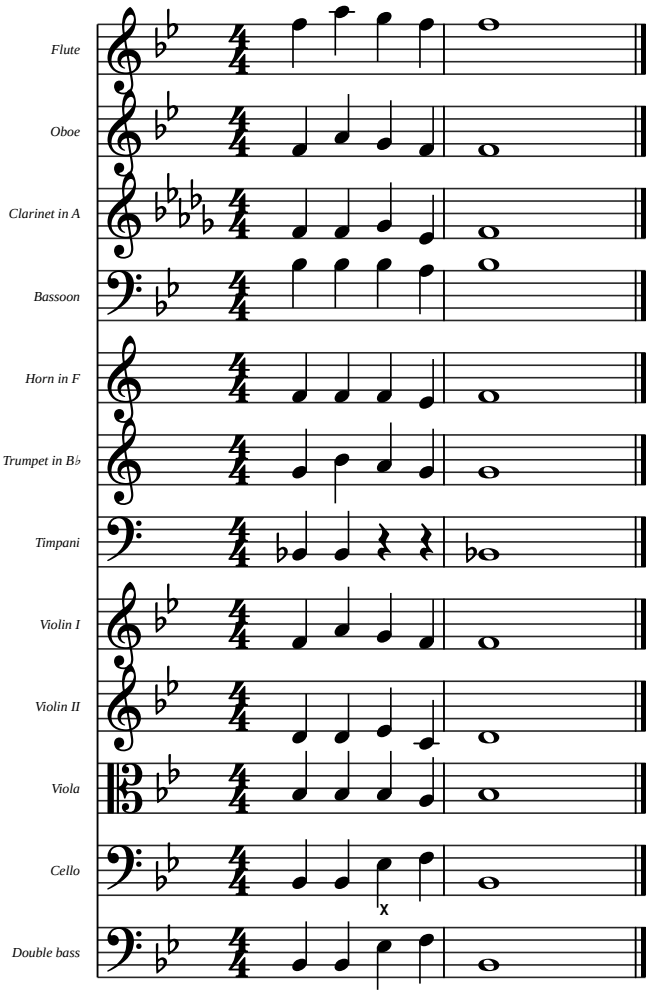
14. In score order, which family comes straight after the brass?



A. strings B. woodwind C. voices D. percussion

3 marks

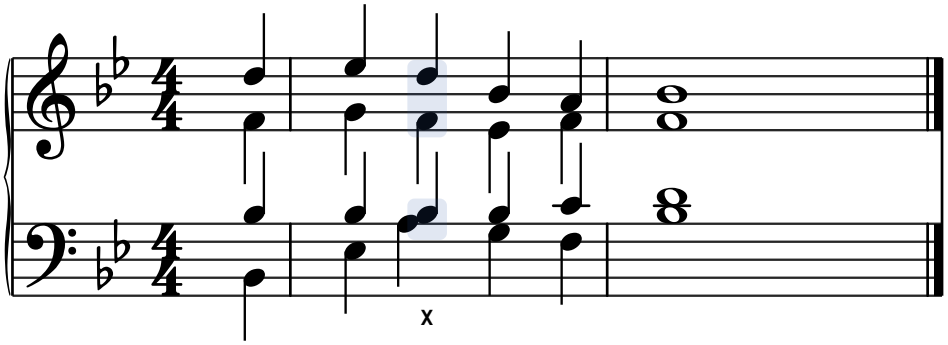
15. This extract sounds in B♭ major. Name the chord at X.



A. II7c B. IV C. IIb D. VII7

3 marks

16. This passage is in B♭ major. Which figures go under the chord marked X?



A. 7 B. ♭6/♭ C. 4/2 D. 6/4

3 marks

17. Which term means "broadly (German)"?

A. breit B. perdendosi C. col legno D. tempo primo (Tempo I)

3 marks

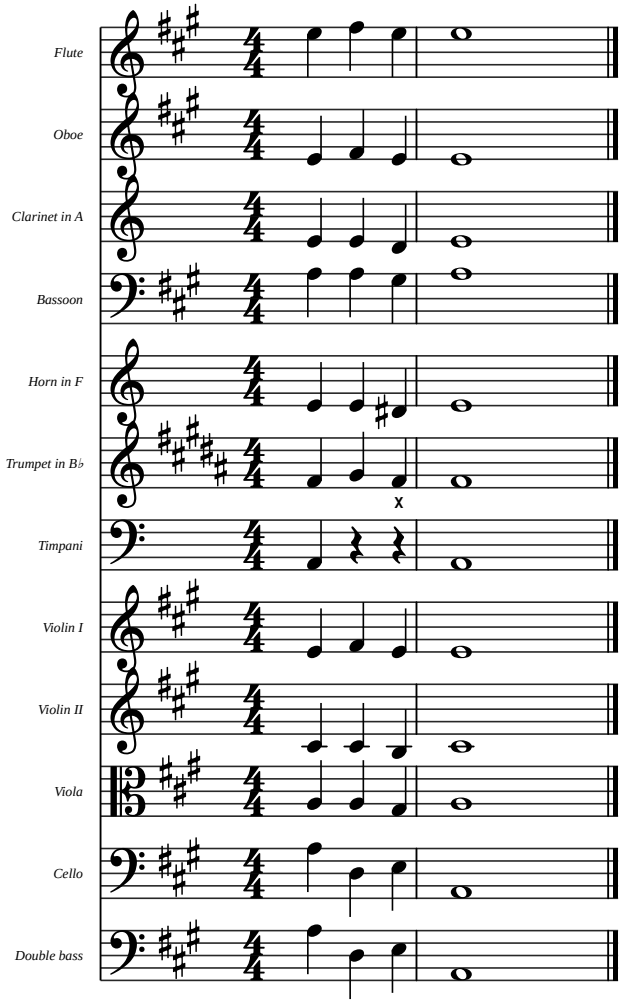
18. What does this mean?

a 2

A. heavily B. both players play the same part C. as if, almost D. broadly (German)

4 marks

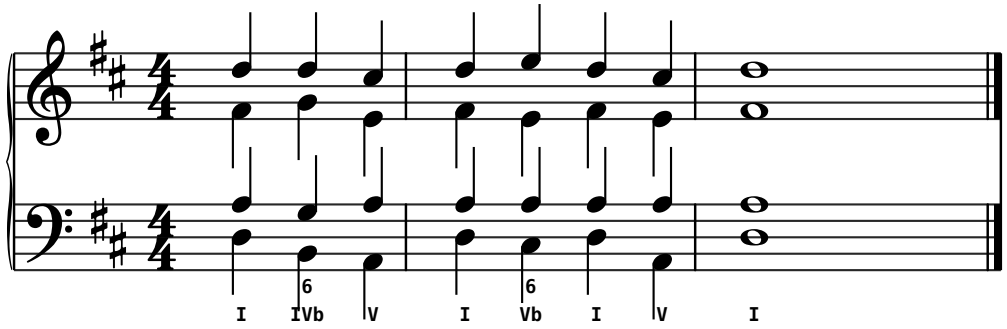
19. Which note actually sounds for the trumpet in B♭ at X?



A. E B. F♯ C. C♯ D. D

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **One good figuring: 5/3 · 6 · 5/3 · 5/3 · 6 · 5/3 · 5/3 · 5/3**.
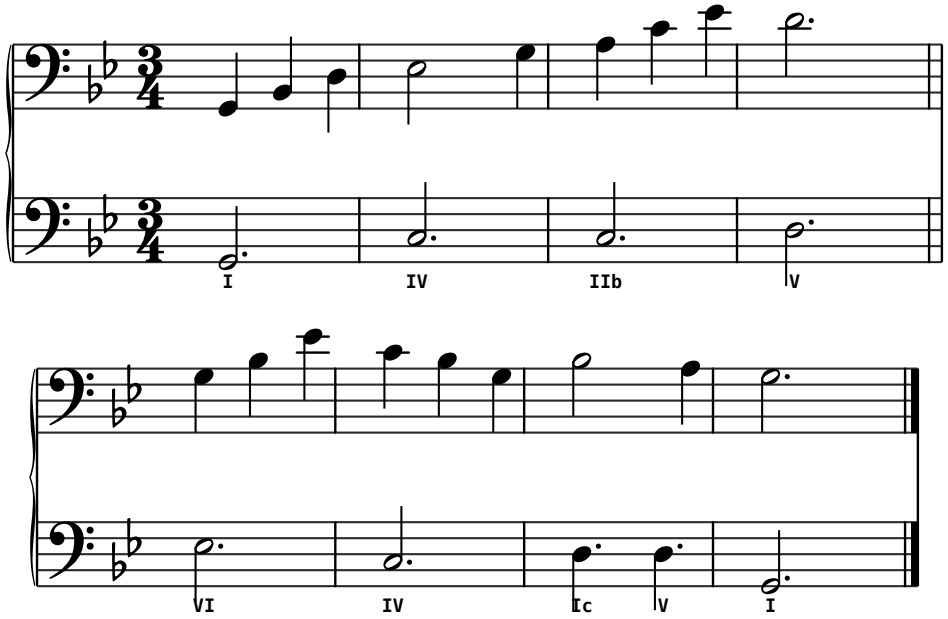


   Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each figure that gives a chord without the melody note or makes a bad progression; 1 for a weaker choice. Other good figurings earn full marks.

2. Q2 · 15m **Ideas that work (other good answers are possible)**.
   - 9–8 suspension in the tenor: hold A3 from chord 2 into chord 3, then fall to G3.
   - 7–6 suspension in the soprano: hold B♭4 from chord 3 into chord 4, then fall to A4.
   - 9–8 suspension in the alto: hold E♭4 from chord 4 into chord 5, then fall to D4.

   Marking: about 4 marks per well-made suspension (prepared, on the beat, resolving down a step, resolution note not doubled) and the rest for stylish decoration that keeps the harmony.

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



   1. Every strong-beat note belongs to the chord underneath (other notes may be passing or auxiliary notes)
   2. The opening's rhythm comes back, changed or developed
   3. A clear shape with a high point, mostly steps with some leaps
   4. Bar 4 sounds like a half-way point (imperfect cadence); bar 8 ends on the tonic
   5. Leading notes rise and 7ths fall where the chords change
   6. It suits the instrument: range, breathing or bowing
   7. Tempo, dynamics with a change, slurs and some articulation

4. Q4 · 3m **D: VI7**. Sounding notes: C, E♭, G, B♭: C–E♭–G–B♭ with C in the bass, so VI7.

5. Q4 · 3m **D: A4**. In the alto clef, middle C is on the middle line. The note at X is A4.
6. Q4 · 3m **B: V**. Sounding notes: C♯, G♯, C♯, E♯: C♯–E♯–G♯ with C♯ in the bass, so V.
7. Q4 · 3m **D: IV**. Sounding notes: E♭, E♭, G, B♭: E♭–G–B♭ with E♭ in the bass, so IV.
8. Q4 · 3m **B: VII7**. X is E♯–G♯–B–D with E♯ in the bass: VII7, a diminished 7th, root position.
9. Q4 · 3m **D: a diminished 7th**. X is C♯–E–G–B♭ (VII7d): a diminished 7th. Built on the raised leading note, it is a stack of minor 3rds; it resolves to I.
10. Q4 · 3m **A: a note of the next chord, sounded early**. Anticipations are common at cadences: the tonic arrives a moment early.
11. Q4 · 4m **B: I**. Sounding notes: B, B, F♯, D: B–D–F♯ with B in the bass, so I.
12. Q5 · 3m **B: the double bass sounds an octave lower**. The double bass always sounds an octave lower than written, so it doubles the cello an octave below.
13. Q5 · 3m **C: percussion**. Score order: woodwind, brass, percussion (here the timpani), then strings.
14. Q5 · 3m **D: percussion**. Score order: woodwind, brass, percussion (here the timpani), then strings.
15. Q5 · 3m **B: IV**. Read the strings (they don't transpose): E♭, B♭, E♭, G: E♭–G–B♭, so IV.
16. Q5 · 3m **C: 4/2**. X is I7d (B♭–D–F–A). Counting up from the bass A: 4 2.
17. Q5 · 3m **A: breit**. breit means "broadly (German)".
18. Q5 · 3m **B: both players play the same part**. a 2 means "both players play the same part".
19. Q5 · 4m **A: E**. A B♭ trumpet sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so it doubles the violin I tune: E.

Grade 7 practice paper 2

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

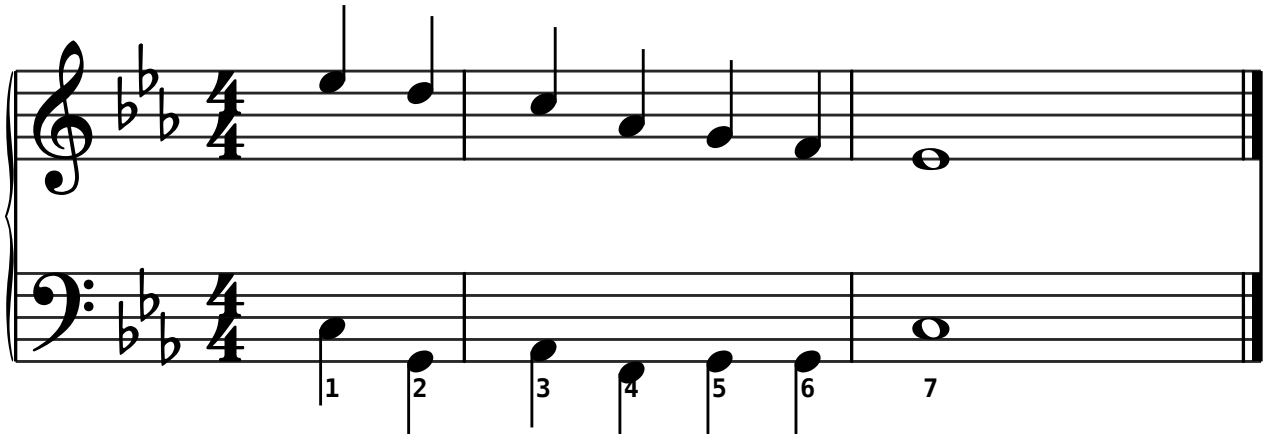
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Question 1: Figuring a bass (15 marks)

15 marks

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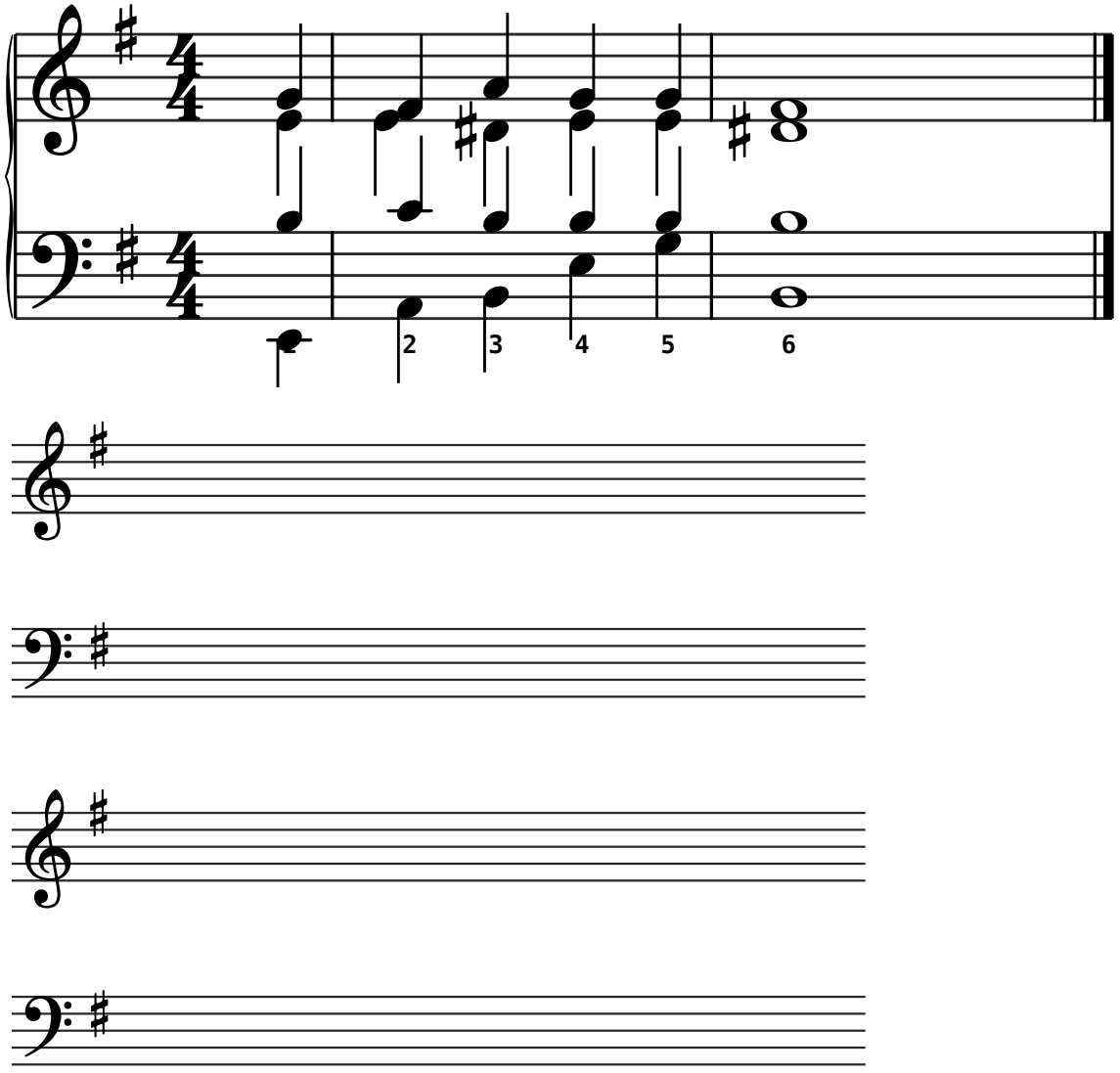


Write the figures under each bass note.

Question 2: Suspensions and decoration (15 marks)

15 marks
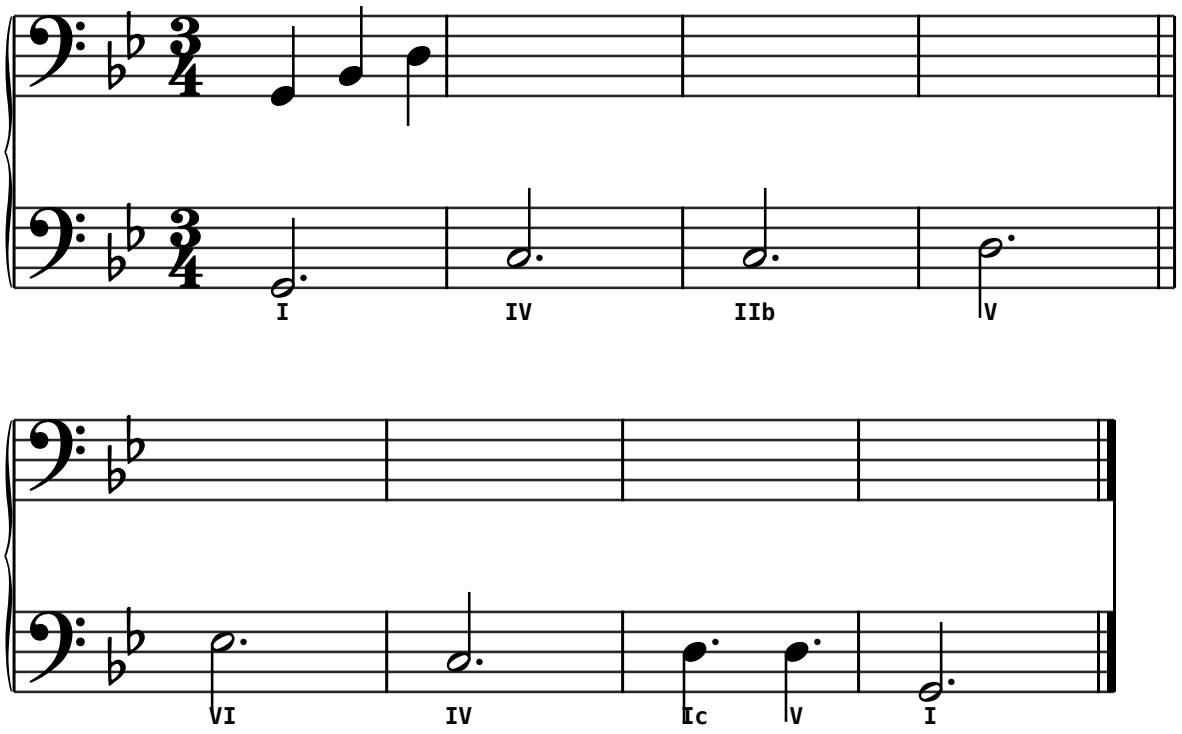
2. Rewrite this passage (E minor) adding at least two suspensions and some melodic decoration (passing notes, auxiliary notes, anticipations). Keep the harmony the same.



Question 3: Composition **(20 marks)**

20 marks

3. Composition: write a melody for cello over this chord plan (G minor). The first bar is given; continue it to the end of bar 8. Add a tempo, dynamics and phrasing.
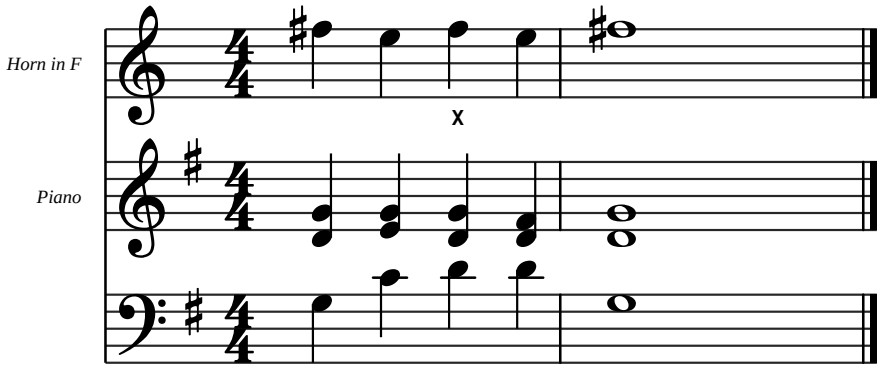


cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Question 4: A solo instrument with piano (25 marks)

3 marks

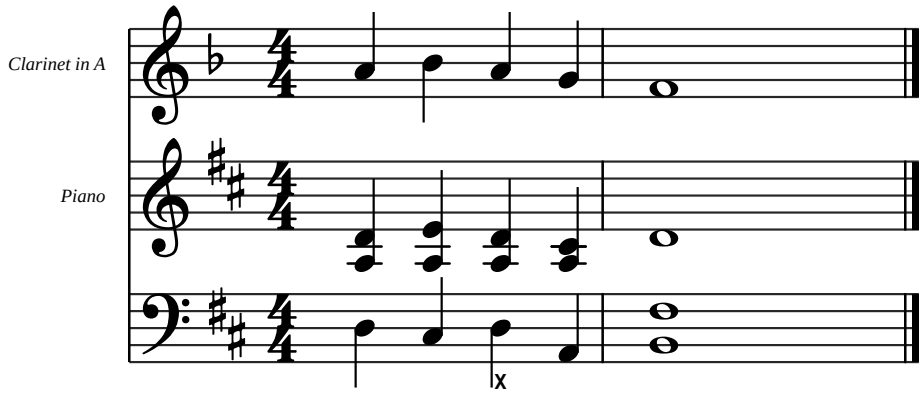
4. The horn in F plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds? (The music sounds in G major.)



A. F♯ B. B C. C D. D

3 marks

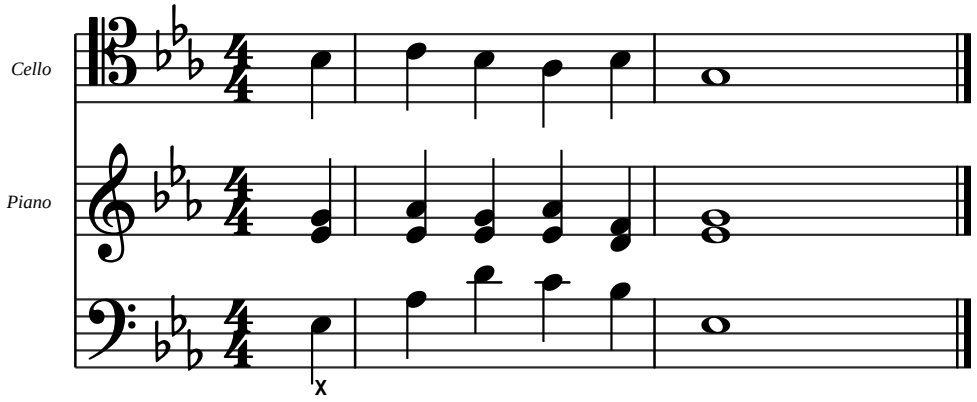
5. The music sounds in D major. Name the chord at X (solo and piano together; remember the solo transposes).



A. VII7d B. I C. IV D. IV7b

3 marks

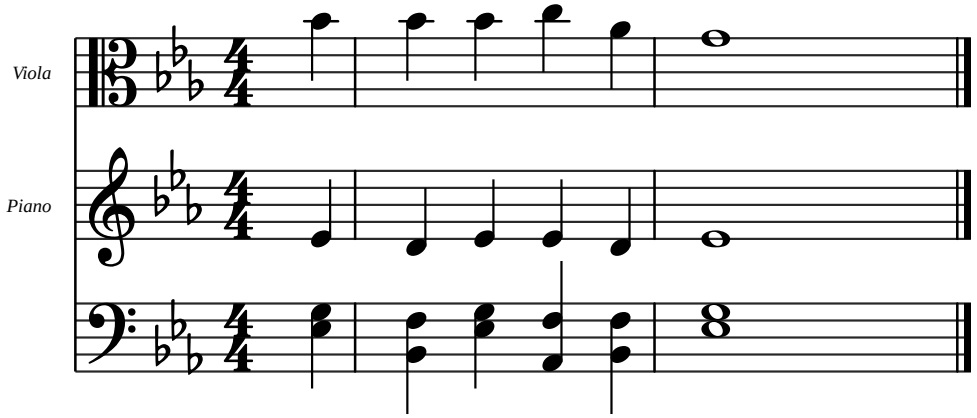
6. The music sounds in E♭ major. Name the chord at X (solo and piano together; remember the solo transposes).



A. IIb B. Ib C. IV7b D. I

3 marks

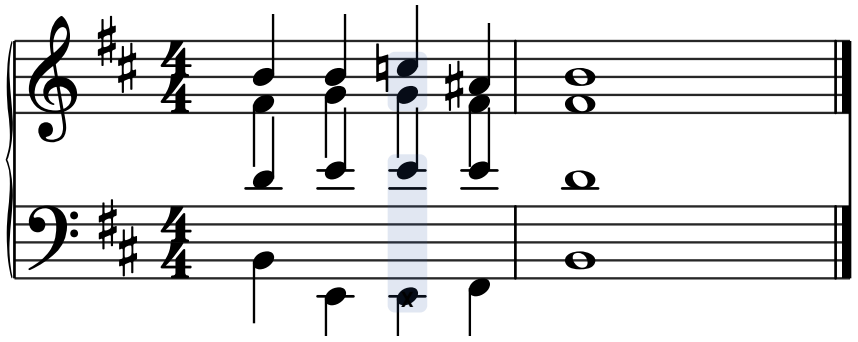
7. Which cadence ends this extract? (E♭ major)



A. perfect B. imperfect C. interrupted D. plagal

3 marks

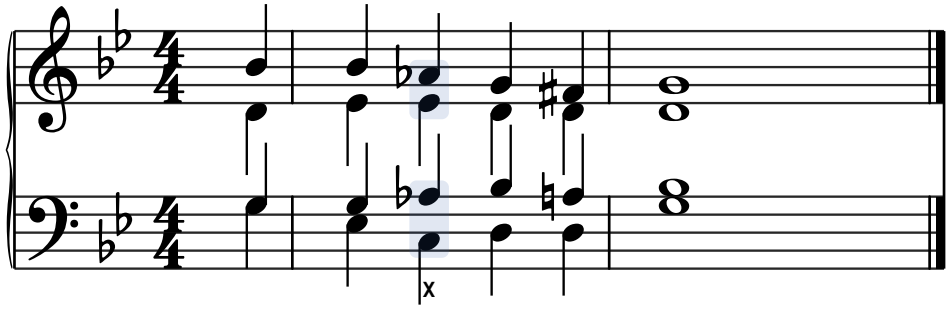
8. This passage is in B minor. Name the chord marked X.



A. VIb B. I7b C. N6 D. VI7b

3 marks

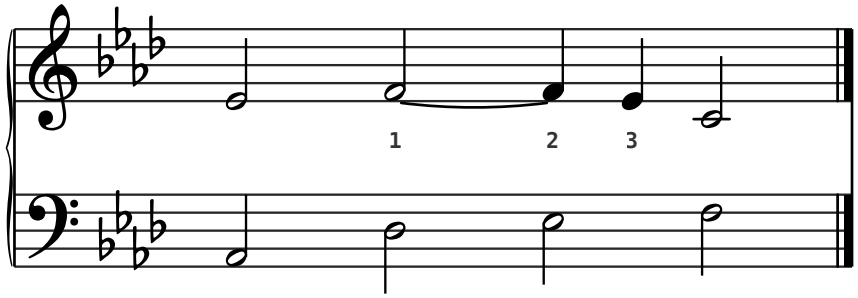
9. This passage is in G minor. What kind of chord is X?



A. a diminished 7th B. a half-diminished 7th (VII7 in a major key) C. a secondary 7th D. a Neapolitan 6th

3 marks

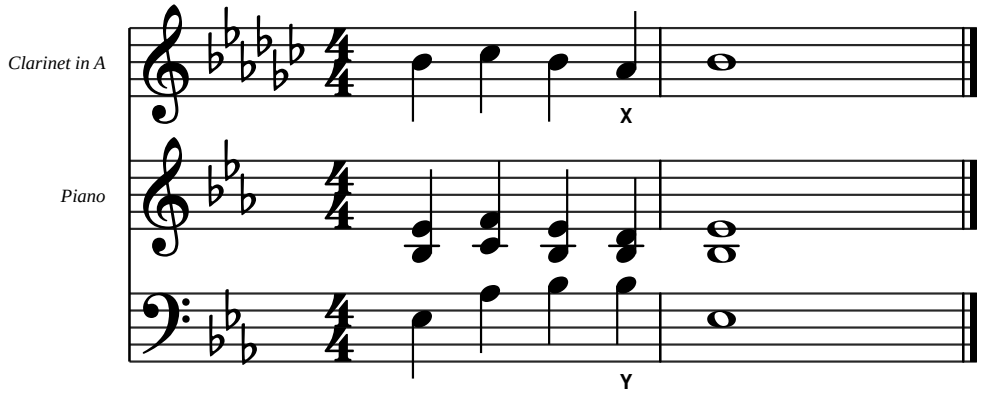
10. Note 2 is a suspension over the bass. What kind? (A♭ major)



A. 7–6 B. 9–8 C. 2–3 D. 4–3

4 marks

11. Name the interval between the SOUNDING note of the clarinet in A at X and the lowest piano note at Y.

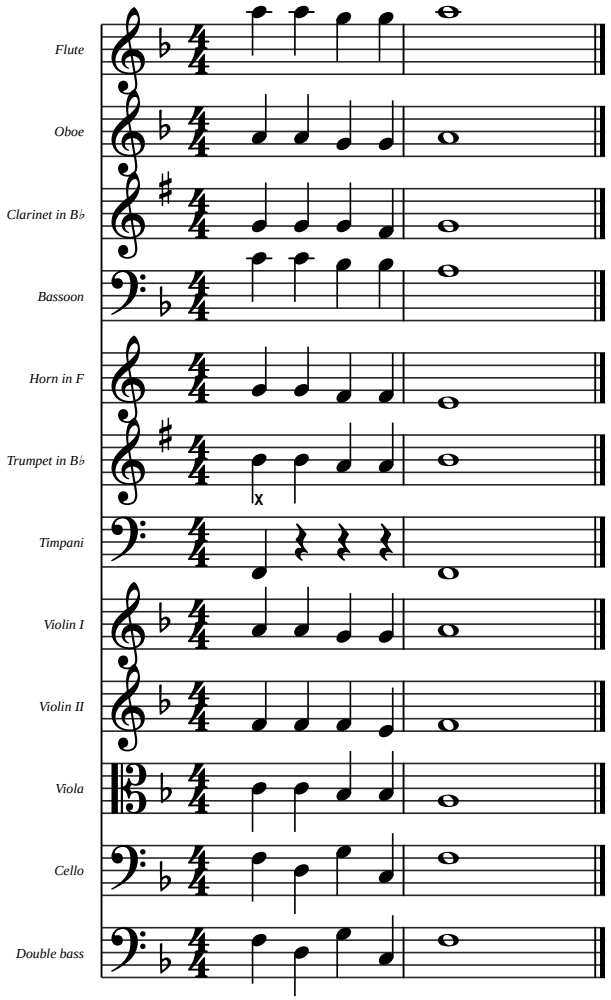


A. minor 5th B. major 5th C. perfect 5th D. perfect 12th

Question 5: An orchestral score (25 marks)

3 marks

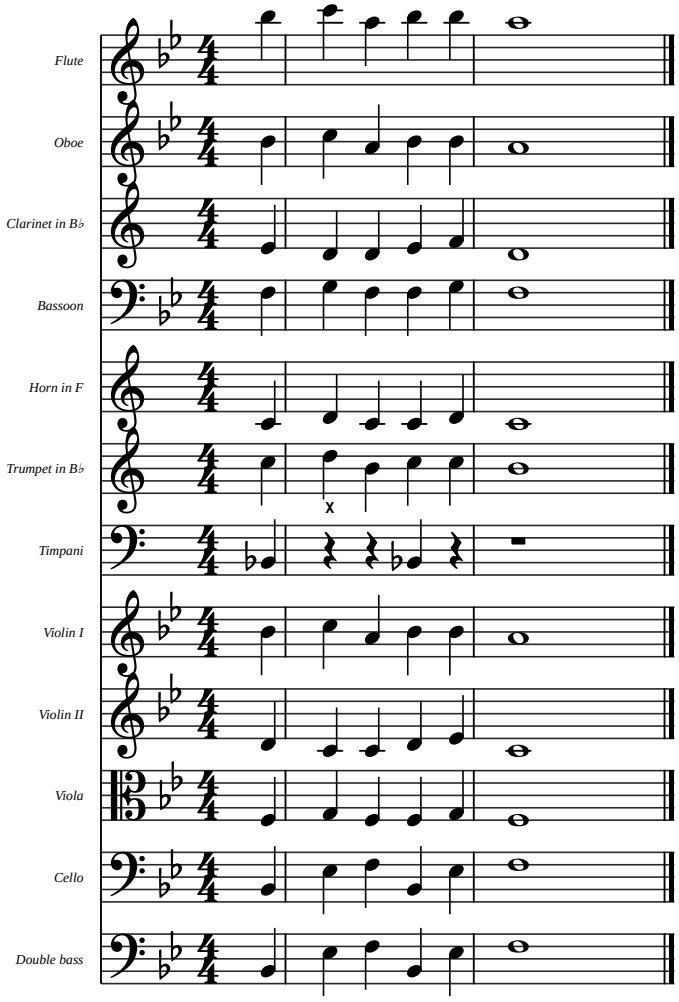
12. Which note actually sounds for the trumpet in B♭ at X?



A. A B. B C. C D. G

3 marks

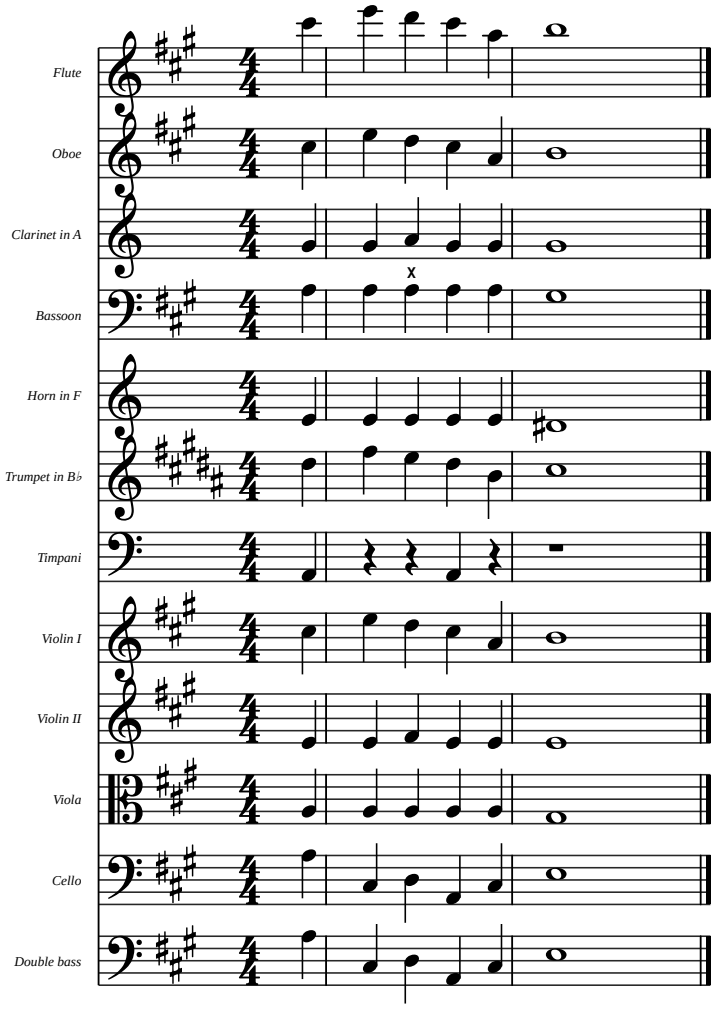
13. Which note actually sounds for the trumpet in B♭ at X?



A. B♭ B. D C. E♭ D. C

3 marks

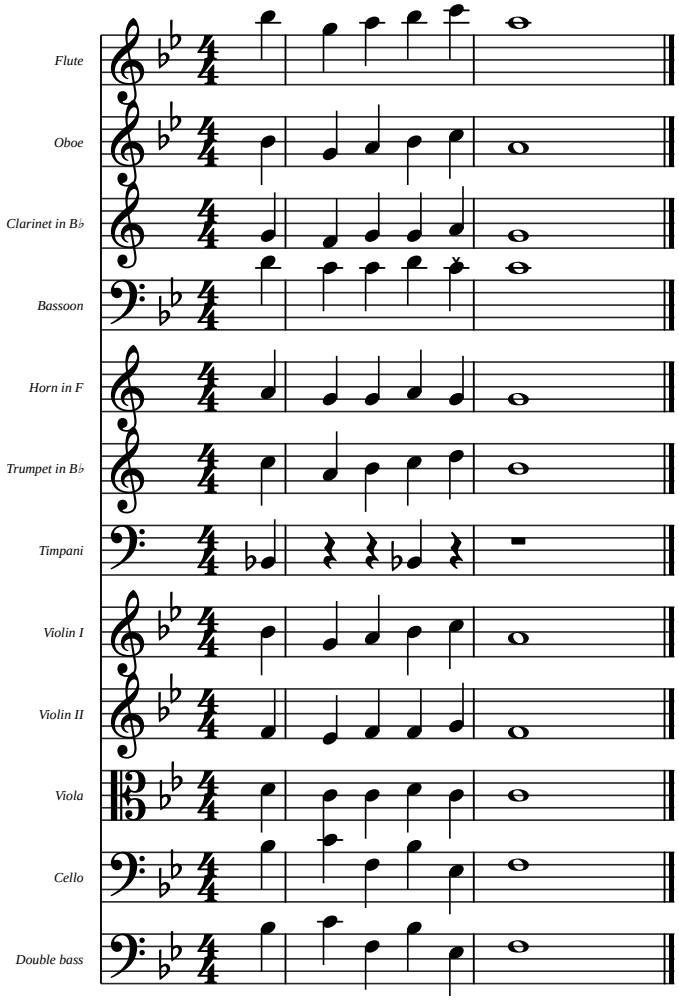
14. The clarinet in A plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?



A. G♯ B. F♯ C. A D. D

3 marks

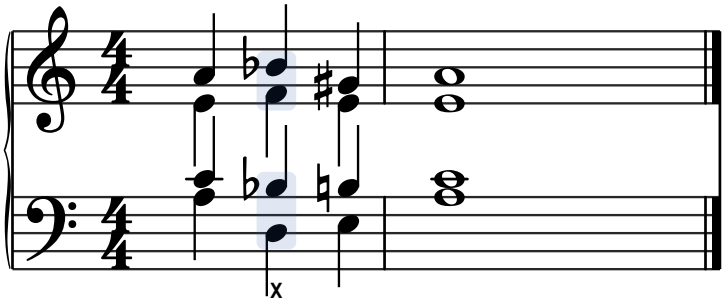
15. The clarinet in B♭ plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?



A. G B. E♭ C. A D. B♭

3 marks

16. This passage is in A minor. Which figures go under the chord marked X?



A. 6/4 B. ♭6 C. 4/3 D. 5/3 (no figure)

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

breit

A. back to the first speed B. divided: players share the notes C. broadly (German) D. go straight on to the next movement

3 marks

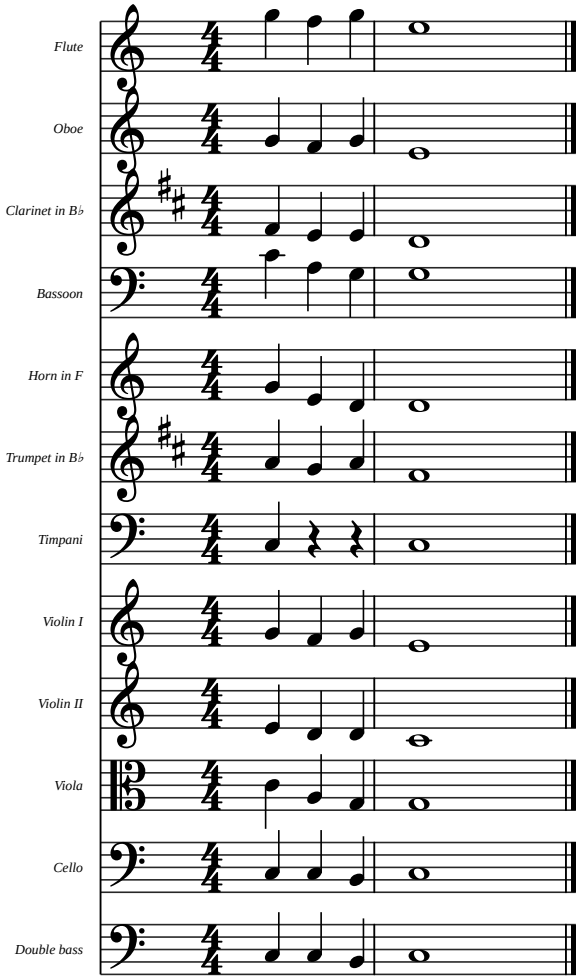
18. What does this mean?

lacrimoso

A. very (French) B. tearful, sad C. stopped: hand in the bell of the horn (German) D. dying away

4 marks

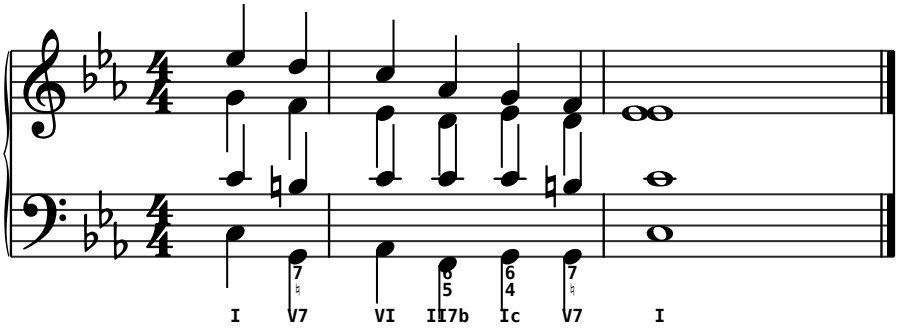
19. The double bass and cello are written on the same notes here. How do they sound?



A. the double bass sounds an octave lower B. the cello sounds an octave lower C. they sound in unison D. the double bass sounds an octave higher

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **One good figuring: 5/3 · 7/♮ · 5/3 · 6/5 · 6/4 · 7/♮ · 5/3**.
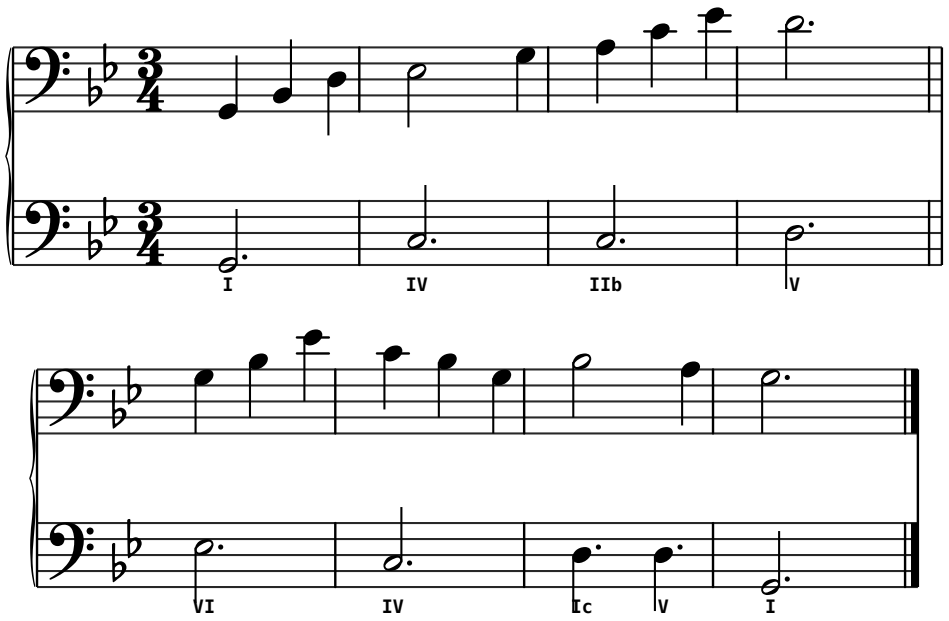


   Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each figure that gives a chord without the melody note or makes a bad progression; 1 for a weaker choice. Other good figurings earn full marks.

2. Q2 · 15m **Ideas that work (other good answers are possible)**.
   - 7–6 suspension in the soprano: hold G4 from chord 1 into chord 2, then fall to F♯4.
   - 4–3 suspension in the alto: hold E4 from chord 2 into chord 3, then fall to D♯4.
   - 9–8 suspension in the tenor: hold C4 from chord 2 into chord 3, then fall to B3.
   - Passing note in the soprano between chords 2 and 3: F♯4–G4–A4 (quavers).
   - Passing note in the bass between chords 4 and 5: E3–F♯3–G3 (quavers).

   Marking: about 4 marks per well-made suspension (prepared, on the beat, resolving down a step, resolution note not doubled) and the rest for stylish decoration that keeps the harmony.

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



   1. Every strong-beat note belongs to the chord underneath (other notes may be passing or auxiliary notes)
   2. The opening's rhythm comes back, changed or developed
   3. A clear shape with a high point, mostly steps with some leaps
   4. Bar 4 sounds like a half-way point (imperfect cadence); bar 8 ends on the tonic
   5. Leading notes rise and 7ths fall where the chords change
   6. It suits the instrument: range, breathing or bowing
   7. Tempo, dynamics with a change, slurs and some articulation

4. Q4 · 3m **B: B**. The horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written: written F♯ sounds as B. You can check it against the piano, which has the same harmony.
5. Q4 · 3m **B: I**. Sounding notes: D, A, D, F♯: D–F♯–A with D in the bass, so I.
6. Q4 · 3m **D: I**. Sounding notes: E♭, E♭, G, B♭: E♭–G–B♭ with E♭ in the bass, so I.
7. Q4 · 3m **A: perfect**. The last two chords are V7–I: a perfect cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **C: N6**. X is C–E–G with E in the bass: N6, a Neapolitan 6th (the major chord on the flattened supertonic, in first inversion).
9. Q4 · 3m **D: a Neapolitan 6th**. X is A♭–C–E♭ (N6): a Neapolitan 6th. Its root is the flattened 2nd of the scale; it usually comes in first inversion and goes to V or Ic–V.
10. Q4 · 3m **B: 9–8**. Note 2 (F) is held over from note 1 and makes a 9th above the bass E♭; it falls to E♭, a octave. So it's a 9–8 suspension.
11. Q4 · 4m **C: perfect 5th**. The solo sounds F (written A♭); the piano bass is B♭. That's a perfect 5th.
12. Q5 · 3m **A: A**. A B♭ trumpet sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so it doubles the violin I tune: A.
13. Q5 · 3m **D: C**. A B♭ trumpet sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so it doubles the violin I tune: C.
14. Q5 · 3m **B: F♯**. The A clarinet sounds a minor 3rd lower than written: written A sounds as F♯ (the same as violin II).
15. Q5 · 3m **A: G**. The B♭ clarinet sounds a major 2nd lower than written: written A sounds as G (the same as violin II).
16. Q5 · 3m **B: ♭6**. X is N6 (B♭–D–F). Counting up from the bass D: ♭6. The accidental shows a note that differs from the key signature.
17. Q5 · 3m **C: broadly (German)**. breit means "broadly (German)".

18. Q5 · 3m **B: tearful, sad**. lacrimoso means "tearful, sad".

19. Q5 · 4m **A: the double bass sounds an octave lower**. The double bass always sounds an octave lower than written, so it doubles the cello an octave below.

Grade 7 practice paper 3

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

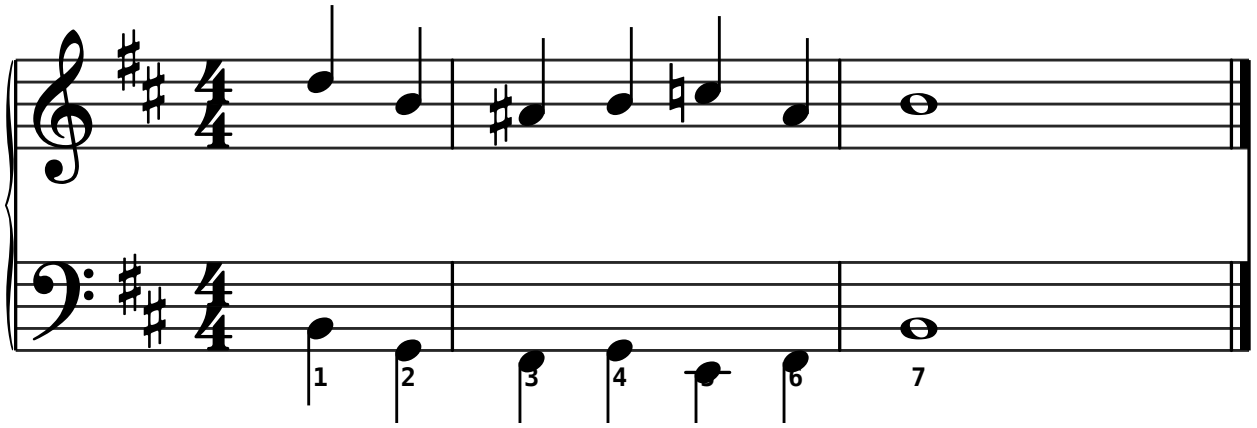
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 7 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each; question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: Figuring a bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. The melody and bass are given (B minor). Choose the figures for each bass note to show the chords. A blank (5/3) means a root-position triad.
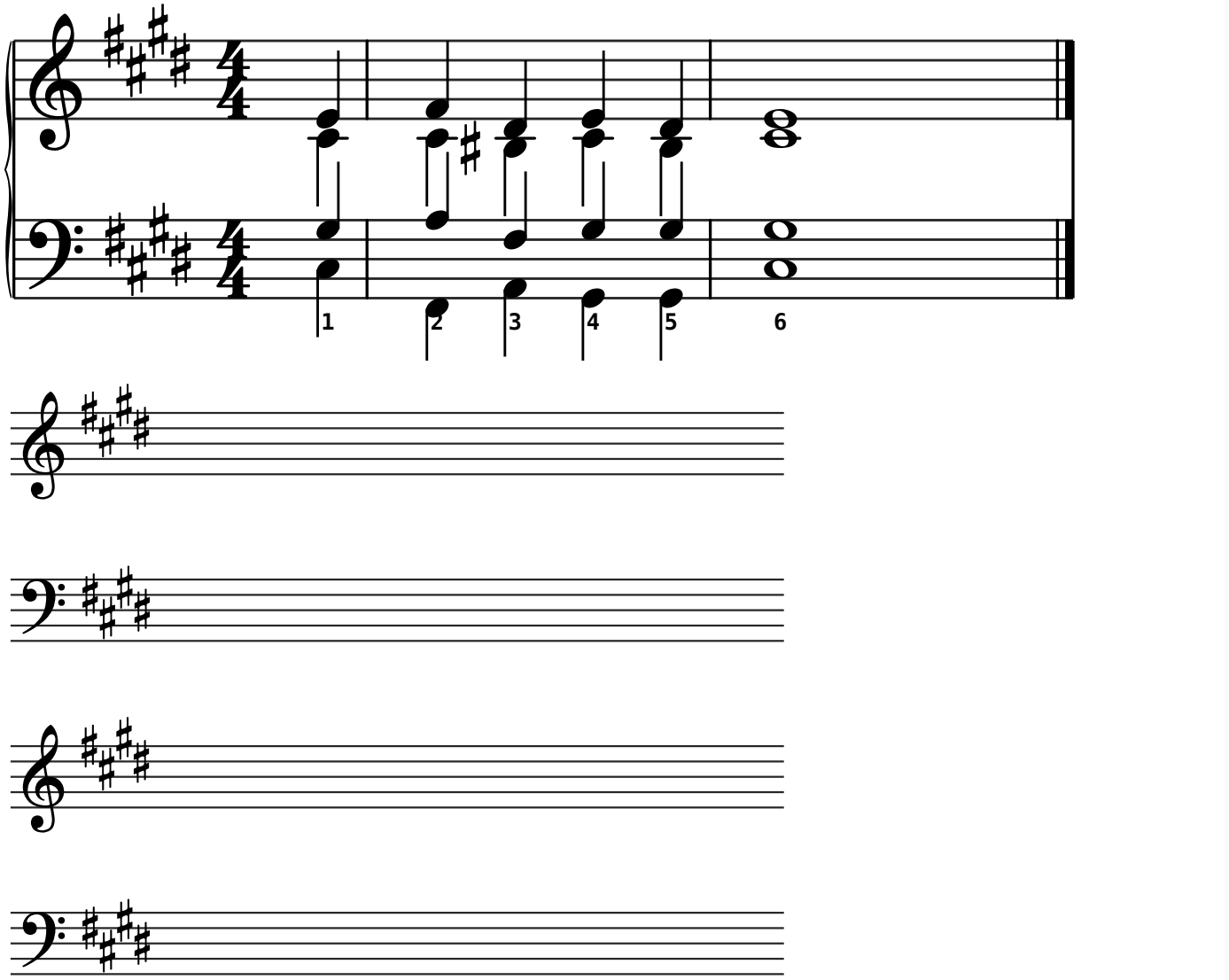


Write the figures under each bass note.

Question 2: Suspensions and decoration (15 marks)

15 marks
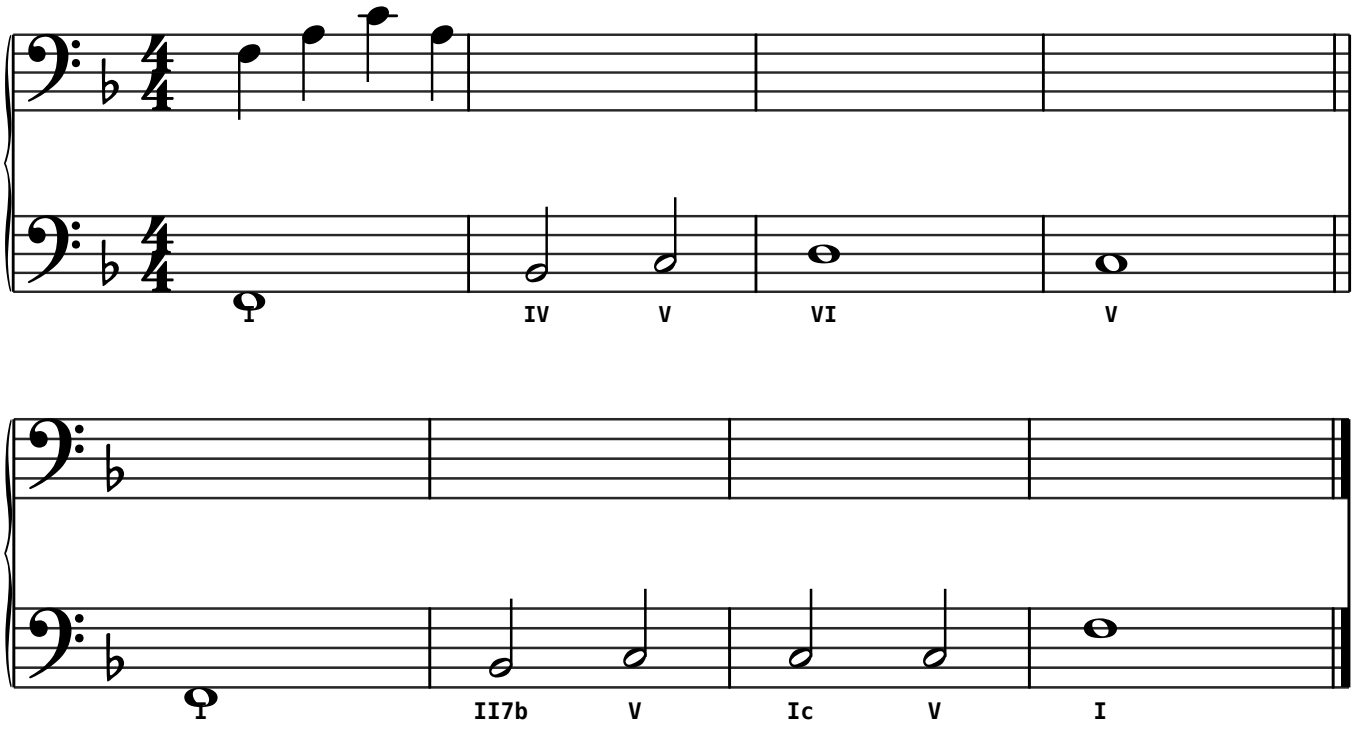
2. Rewrite this passage (C♯ minor) adding at least two suspensions and some melodic decoration (passing notes, auxiliary notes, anticipations). Keep the harmony the same.



Question 3: Composition **(20 marks)**

20 marks

3. Composition: write a melody for cello over this chord plan (F major). The first bar is given; continue it to the end of bar 8. Add a tempo, dynamics and phrasing.

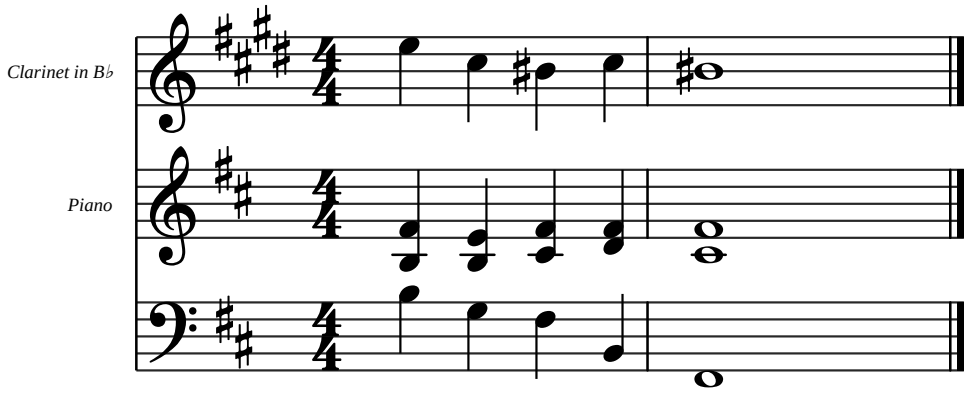


cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Question 4: A solo instrument with piano (25 marks)

3 marks
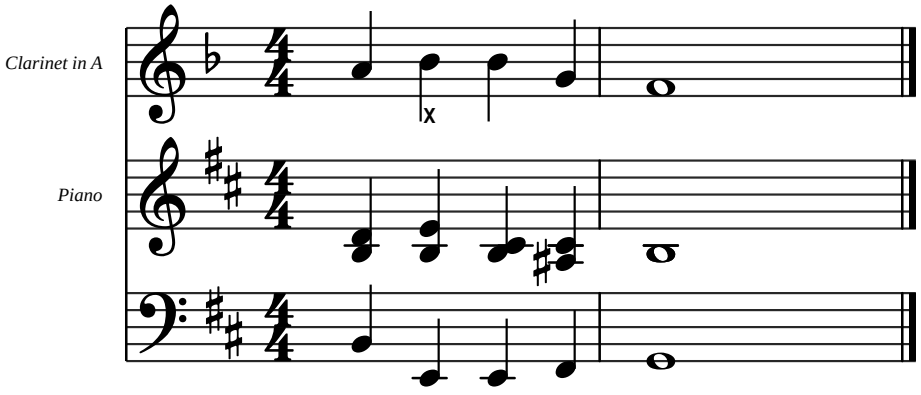
4. Which cadence ends this extract? (B minor)



A. perfect B. plagal C. interrupted D. imperfect

3 marks

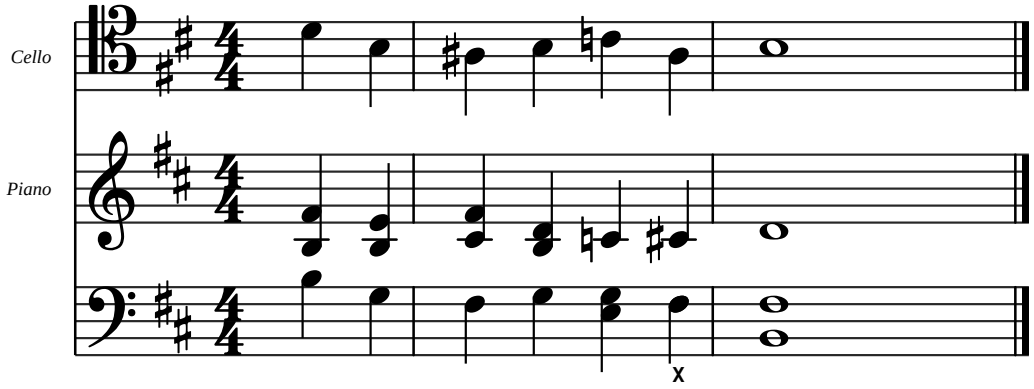
5. The clarinet in A plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds? (The music sounds in B minor.)



A. E B. F♯ C. A D. G

3 marks

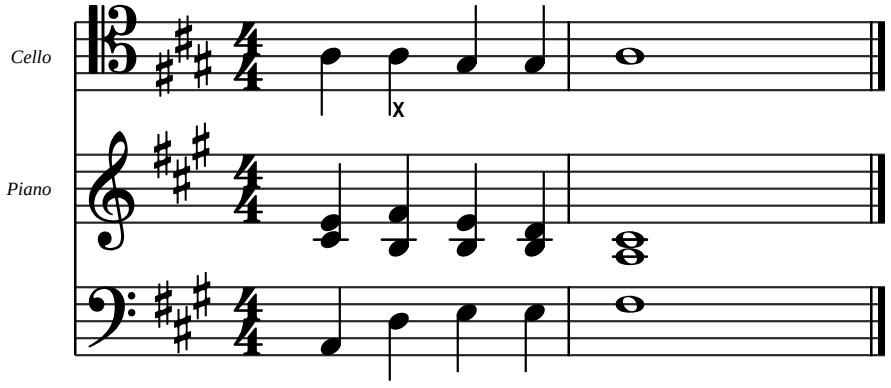
6. The music sounds in B minor. Name the chord at X (solo and piano together; remember the solo transposes).



A. I7 B. V7d C. VII7c D. V

3 marks

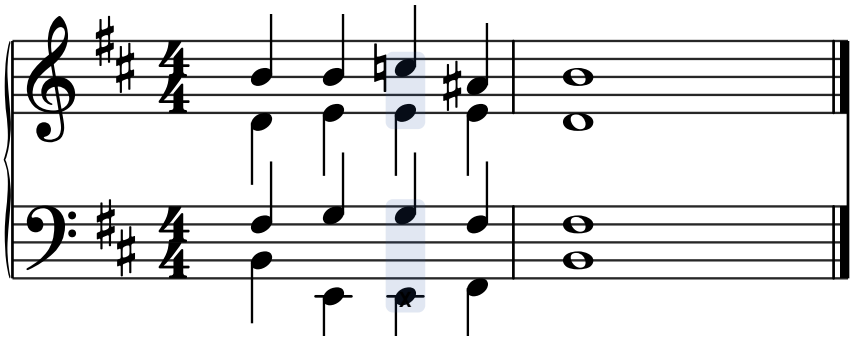
7. Name the cello's note marked X (tenor clef). Give the octave too: middle C is C4.



A. A3 B. C♯4 C. B3 D. A2

3 marks

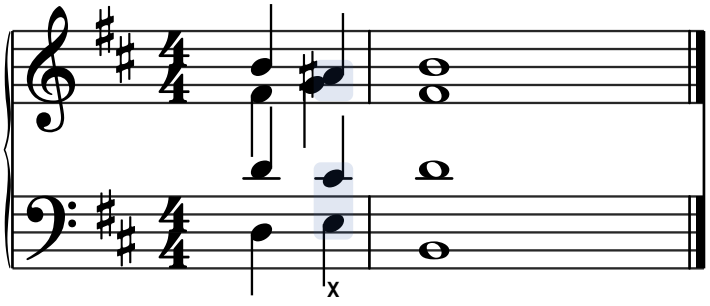
8. This passage is in B minor. What kind of chord is X?



A. a half-diminished 7th (VII7 in a major key) B. a secondary 7th C. a Neapolitan 6th D. a diminished 7th

3 marks

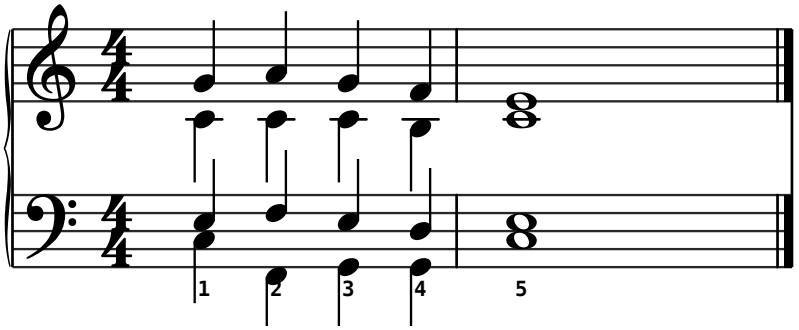
9. This passage is in B minor. Which figures go under the chord marked X?



A. 6/4 B. 6 C. 4/3 D. ♯4/3

3 marks

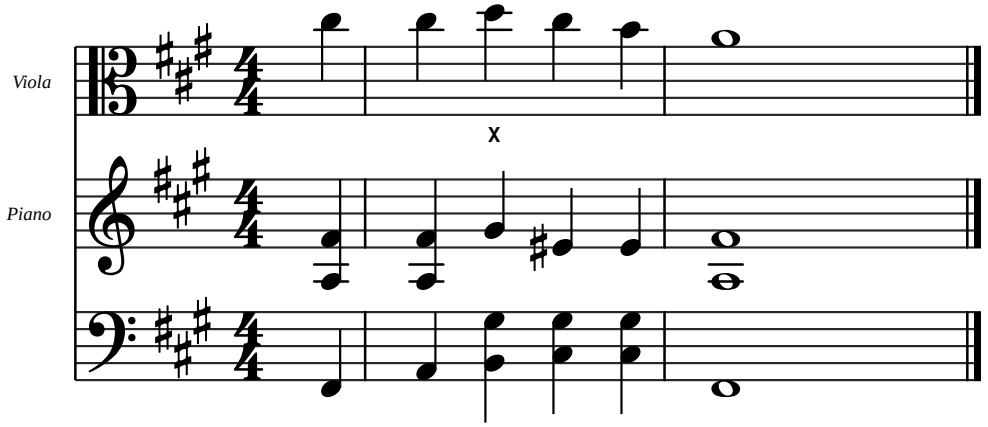
10. Where could you add a suspension? (C major)



A. alto, into chord 4 B. alto, into chord 3 C. soprano, into chord 2 D. tenor, into chord 2

4 marks

11. Name the viola's note marked X (alto clef). Give the octave too: middle C is C4.

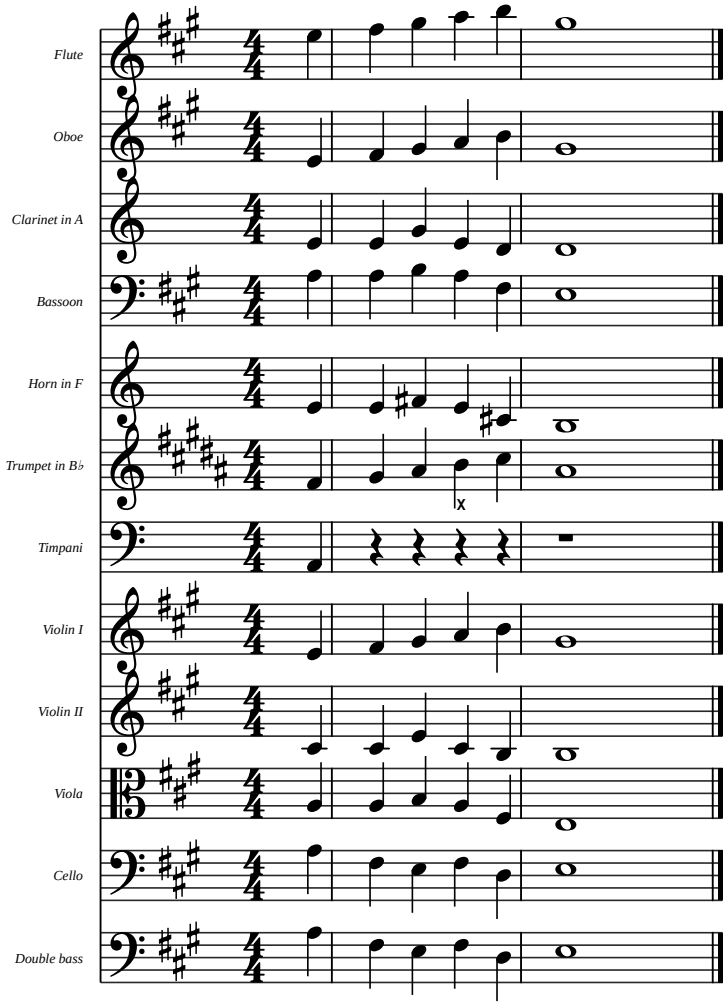


A. C♯5 B. E5 C. F♯5 D. D5

Question 5: An orchestral score (25 marks)

3 marks

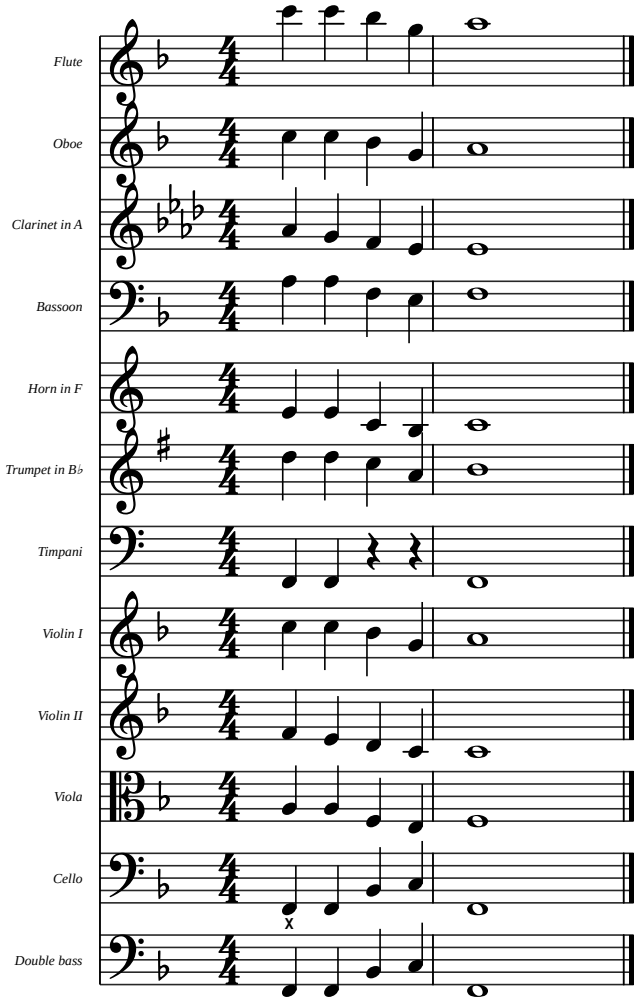
12. Which note actually sounds for the trumpet in B♭ at X?



A. B B. C♯ C. G♯ D. A

3 marks

13. This extract sounds in F major. Name the chord at X.



A. I
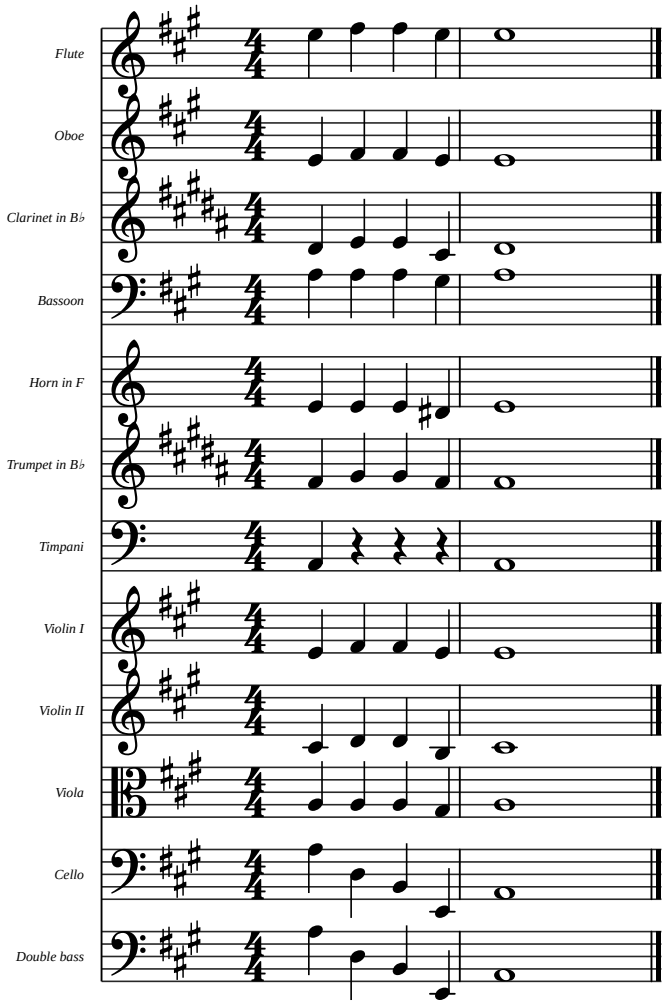
B. II7

C. IVc

D. IV7b

3 marks

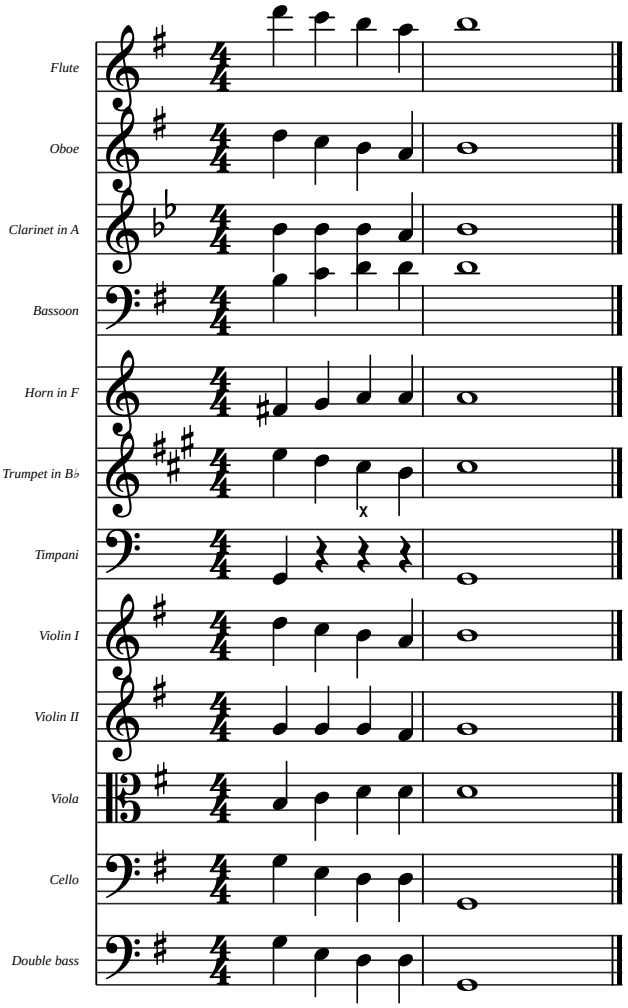
14. How many of these staves are for woodwind instruments?



A. 3 B. 4 C. 6 D. 5

3 marks

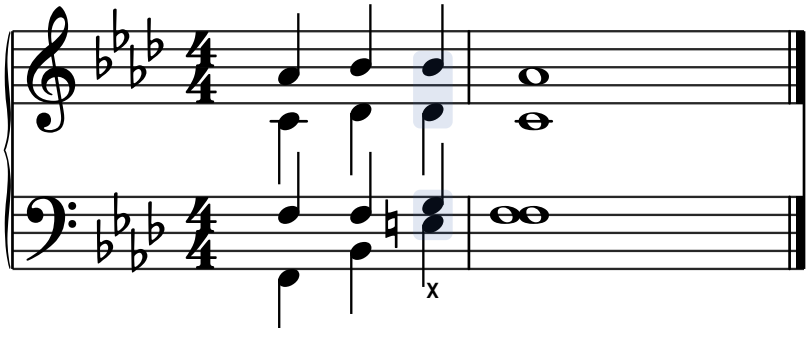
15. Which note actually sounds for the trumpet in B♭ at X?



A. C B. B C. C♯ D. D

3 marks

16. This passage is in F minor. Name the chord marked X.



A. VII7 B. VII7c C. IV D. IVc

3 marks

17. Which term means "brought out, prominent (French)"?

A. breit B. en dehors C. divisi (div.) D. un peu

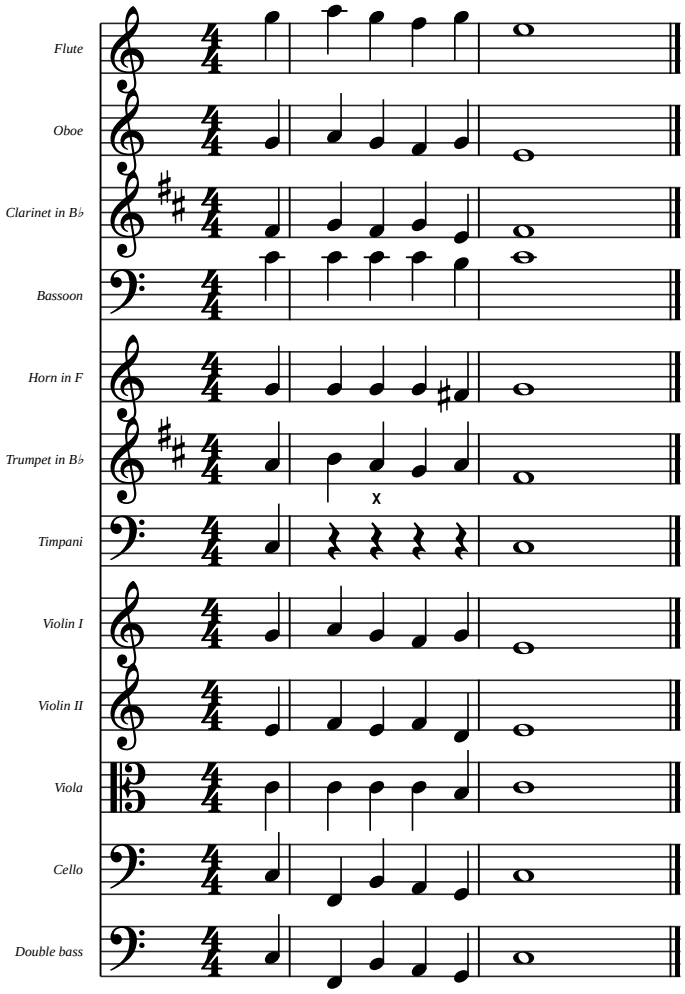
3 marks

18. Which term means "go straight on to the next movement"?

A. morendo B. col legno C. a 2 D. attacca

4 marks

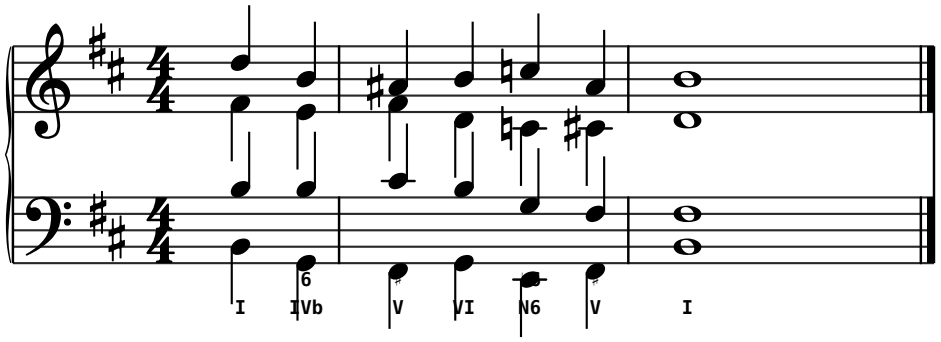
19. Which note actually sounds for the trumpet in B♭ at X?



A. A B. B C. G D. F

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **One good figuring: 5/3 · 6 · ♯ · 5/3 · ♮6 · ♯ · 5/3**.

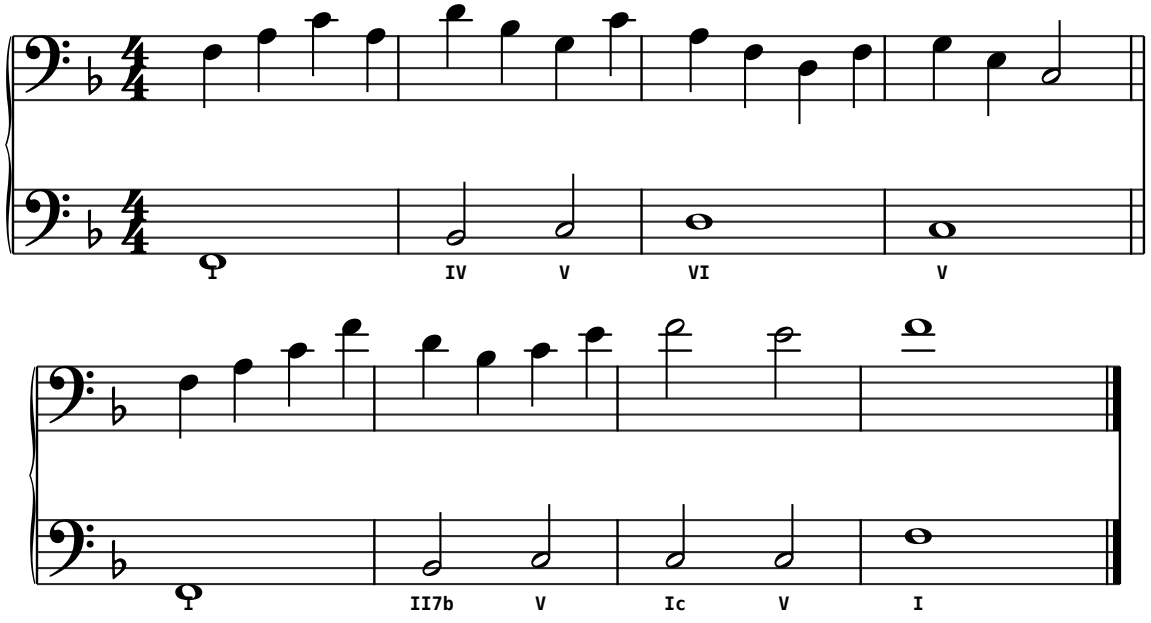


Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each figure that gives a chord without the melody note or makes a bad progression; 1 for a weaker choice. Other good figurings earn full marks.

2. Q2 · 15m **Ideas that work (other good answers are possible)**.
   - 4–3 suspension in the alto: hold C♯4 from chord 4 into chord 5, then fall to B♯3.
   - Passing note in the soprano between chords 2 and 3: F♯4–E4–D♯4 (quavers).
   - Passing note in the tenor between chords 2 and 3: A3–G♯3–F♯3 (quavers).
   - Passing note in the bass between chords 2 and 3: F♯2–G♯2–A2 (quavers).

   Marking: about 4 marks per well-made suspension (prepared, on the beat, resolving down a step, resolution note not doubled) and the rest for stylish decoration that keeps the harmony.

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



1. Every strong-beat note belongs to the chord underneath (other notes may be passing or auxiliary notes)
2. The opening's rhythm comes back, changed or developed
3. A clear shape with a high point, mostly steps with some leaps
4. Bar 4 sounds like a half-way point (imperfect cadence); bar 8 ends on the tonic
5. Leading notes rise and 7ths fall where the chords change
6. It suits the instrument: range, breathing or bowing
7. Tempo, dynamics with a change, slurs and some articulation

4. Q4 · 3m **D: imperfect**. The last two chords are I–V: an imperfect cadence.
5. Q4 · 3m **D: G**. The clarinet in A sounds a minor 3rd lower than written: written B♭ sounds as G. You can check it against the piano, which has the same harmony.
6. Q4 · 3m **D: V**. Sounding notes: F♯, F♯, C♯, A♯: F♯–A♯–C♯ with F♯ in the bass, so V.
7. Q4 · 3m **A: A3**. In the tenor clef, middle C is on the 4th line up. The note at X is A3.
8. Q4 · 3m **C: a Neapolitan 6th**. X is C–E–G (N6): a Neapolitan 6th. Its root is the flattened 2nd of the scale; it usually comes in first inversion and goes to V or Ic–V.
9. Q4 · 3m **D: ♯4/3**. X is VII7c (A♯–C♯–E–G). Counting up from the bass E: ♯4 3. The accidental shows a note that differs from the key signature.
10. Q4 · 3m **A: alto, into chord 4**. In the alto, hold C from chord 3 into chord 4, then fall to B: a 4–3 suspension. It works because that part already moves down by step there, the held note clashes with the new bass on the beat, and the note it resolves to isn't doubled.
11. Q4 · 4m **D: D5**. In the alto clef, middle C is on the middle line. The note at X is D5.
12. Q5 · 3m **D: A**. A B♭ trumpet sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so it doubles the violin I tune: A.
13. Q5 · 3m **A: I**. Read the strings (they don't transpose): F, A, F, C: F–A–C, so I.
14. Q5 · 3m **B: 4**. Flute, oboe, clarinet and bassoon: four woodwind staves, at the top of the score.
15. Q5 · 3m **B: B**. A B♭ trumpet sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so it doubles the violin I tune: B.
16. Q5 · 3m **A: VII7**. X is E–G–B♭–D♭ with E in the bass: VII7, a diminished 7th, root position.
17. Q5 · 3m **B: en dehors**. en dehors means "brought out, prominent (French)".
18. Q5 · 3m **D: attacca**. attacca means "go straight on to the next movement".
19. Q5 · 4m **C: G**. A B♭ trumpet sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so it doubles the violin I tune: G.